POST-APOCALYPTIC FRONTIER GOTHIC



TESTAMENT OF DUST

A Setting for The 2d12 System · Version 2

SETTING BOOK

Roads through a broken world. Blood behind every bargain.

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2026-11-07

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A Setting for The 2d12 System · Version 2 · Setting Book

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Version 2 · Setting compilation dated 2026-11-07

Testament of Dust is an original setting for the 2d12 System. You need The 2d12 System *core rulebook to play.*
Roads through a broken world. Blood behind every bargain.
The 2d12 System draws inspiration from Fate, the Cypher System, :Otherscape, Mouse Guard, Blades in the Dark and the 2d20 System; all trademarks belong to their owners.

Playtest draft — not yet playtested. Set in EB Garamond and Cinzel.

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CHAPTER I

Introduction

The old world is buried beneath the present, but it has not fallen silent. This chapter explains what this book contains, what it needs from the core rulebook and how its rules are named.

Fences of wood and garlic. Laser rifles beside wooden stakes. Somewhere beyond the ridge, an estate light comes on.

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About This Book

This setting book holds everything specific to *Testament of Dust*: the Frontier, its rules for vampires, blood and old-world works, and the Descriptors, Playbooks and Focuses written for it. It is not a complete game. You also need *The 2d12 System* core rulebook, which holds the engine and the generic material the Frontier builds on.

Ch.	Chapter	Contents
I	Introduction	What you need, terminology, renamed stats, notation
II	Frontier Rules	The Frontier setting: Campaign Truths, skills, day and night, vampires, the Bled, afflicted blood, killing methods, old-world works, contracts, conflicts, travel, Woe spends
III	Frontier Descriptors	20 Descriptors with Frontier hooks
IV	Frontier Playbooks	Sellsword, Stalker, Frontier Doctor, Broker, Rider, Occultist, Mutant, Cyborg Hunter, Warden
V	Frontier Focuses	20 setting Focuses, including the dhampir Focus
App.	Frontier Quick Reference	Day and night, Frontier skills and vampire Woe spends at a glance

What comes from the core rulebook. References to Core Rules, Optional Modules, Generic Descriptors, Generic Playbooks and Generic Focuses point to *The 2d12 System*. For example, Core Rules §4.1 means section 4.1 of the Core Rules chapter in that book. References to the Frontier chapters point to this book, and a bare reference such as §6 points to a section in the same chapter. Where a Frontier rule and a core rule conflict, the Frontier rule wins.

Optional Modules. On the Frontier, all three modules in *The 2d12 System* are recommended: Cyphers & Artifacts for old-world works, The Grind & Travel for the long roads between towns, and the Truth-Driven Sandbox for a world written in Campaign Truths.

Terminology and Renamed Stats

The source documents used the working names on the left. This book uses the house names on the right everywhere: in rules text, tables, abilities, gear and playbook names.

Working name	House name	What it is
Threat	Woe	The GM's pool: complications, escalation, vampire Woe spends
Momentum	Momentum	The party's shared pool of surplus Power (unchanged)
Fate / Fate Points	Tychē / Tychē Points	Each PC's narrative currency: invoke tags, accept compels; set by Refresh
Vitality	Sōma	Pool: strength, endurance, toughness. Resists wounds, poison, exhaustion, cold
Alacrity	Mētis	Pool: speed, precision, stealth, reflexes. Resists traps, falls, being caught
Mind	Psychē	Pool: intellect, perception, memory, cunning. Resists confusion, illusion, deception
Spirit	Pneuma	Pool: will, presence, faith, the supernatural. Resists fear, despair, possession, corruption

Working name	House name	Generic core playbook
Bruiser	Bellator	Front-line muscle; anchor Fight or Brawl
Operator	Furcifer	Infiltrator, scout, thief; anchor Stealth
Sage	Savant	Scholar, detective, scientist; anchor Lore or Investigate
Face	Interlocutor	Diplomat, con artist, leader; anchor Persuade
Wayfarer	Explorator	Ranger, pilot, explorer; anchor Survival
Adept	Adept	Mage, psychic, hacker; anchor Arcana or Tech (unchanged)

- Pool shorthand. Playbook stat blocks list base pools as Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne (Sōma / Mētis / Psychē / Pneuma).
- Scars take the name of the pool most tied to the condition that caused them: a Pneuma Scar, a Psychē Scar (Core Rules §6.3).
- Names left as they are. In-world names that use the everyday words keep them, because they describe the fiction rather than a stat: the Spirit Duel conflict type, the abilities Spirit Sight, Shared Spirit, Steady Mind and Archive Mind, and the Focus Sends the Mind Abroad. Credits to the source games (Fate, Fate Core, 2d20) also keep their original names.

Notation

- ★ Major. An ability that costs 1 Refresh when you take it, at creation or through advancement.
- ◆ Capstone. Unlocked after 12 Advances if you have at least 4 abilities from that playbook. It costs no Refresh, and each character can have one.
- ◈ Weird. A Focus that assumes the supernatural, old-world works or afflicted blood. On the Frontier every ◈ Focus is allowed, but the marker shows which ones draw the attention of vampire households, Occultists and frightened villagers.
- Tags are written in *italics*, such as *marks on my throat*. Statuses add a tier, such as *wounded-2*.
- Difficulty is written by name and target, such as Standard 15 or Hard 18.

A NOTE ON TONE

The Frontier is gothic horror on a post-apocalyptic frontier: lone riders, dusty towns, shuttered estates, laser rifles beside wooden stakes, blood ledgers and disputed wills, and vampires who are few, long-lived and indispensable. Players can be dhampirs, but not full vampires (Frontier Rules §1).

CHAPTER II

Frontier Rules

The old world is buried beneath the present, but it has not fallen silent. This chapter covers the setting: Campaign Truths, day and night, vampires and the blood they need, the bled, dhampirs, how the afflicted die, old-world works, contracts and the long roads between towns.

Every door in this valley opens for someone. Find out who, and you'll know who rules it.

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1. The Setting in Brief

The old world is buried beneath the present, but it has not fallen silent. Its roads, foundations and sealed rooms are everywhere; a few of its works still run. No one agrees on when it fell, and every claim to rule rests on a history that cannot all be true.

Across the Frontier — wherever law, knowledge and working infrastructure give out — towns bargain with ancient households, physicians dispute the teachings of religious orders, and courts fight over succession, charters and the machines that keep people alive.

Among the living are vampires: people who must take blood to live. They are few, long-lived, hard to kill and often indispensable. Some claim to remember the world before the fall. Most rule nothing; some rule a great deal. Their dhampir children are rarer still.

Tone: grim, gothic, political. Locked rooms and disputed wills, blood ledgers and charity clinics, rifles beside silver knives, and monsters who know every family in town.

Players can be dhampirs (see the Focus *Carries Her Mother's Blood*) but not full vampires.

2. Campaign Truths

Agree on these at session zero. The first five are the core Truths. Replace or add to them from the optional list.

2.1 Core Truths

#	Truth	In play
1	The Kept are few and indispensable	Vampires are rare. A single vampire is a campaign arc, not a random encounter — and killing one rarely solves the problem it was part of.
2	Blood behind every bargain	Every vampire depends on a supply: a household, a levy or an exchange. The supply is politics.
3	The Frontier pays for answers and fears them	Towns hire investigators and Hunters because they must. They don't always want what's found.
4	The old world's works are disputed	Machines, miracles, curses and hauntings are argued over by physicians, priests and scholars. Science and Occult both apply (§3).
5	Dhampirs are rare, feared and coveted	Common folk fear them. Vampire households want them — as heirs, keys or worse.

2.2 Optional Truths (d12)

d12	Truth
1	A founder still lives — one of the oldest vampires in the region controls a bloodline whose doors open across half the region.
2	No one rules the whole Frontier — no higher power is coming to settle disputes.
3	Some vampires want to end it — certain vampires seek death, love, escape, or a cure that may not exist.
4	The machines still run — old-world works keep operating with no one in charge, defended by guardians nobody controls.
5	Old oaths bind the retainers — hereditary retainer clans serve vampire households for pay, loyalty or debt.
6	Hunters compete for bounties — rival crews race for every contract. Bounties go to whoever brings back the proof.
7	The weather is a weapon — old weather works still run in places and still fail.
8	The bled are suspected — local law says anyone fed on by a vampire must be examined, confined or exiled, in case they turn.
9	The old faith keeps the old rites — the rites are older than anyone can explain, and some of them work.
10	Mutants are people too — mutants live everywhere, and how they're treated is a frontier politics question.
11	The lights in the sky still move — something the old world left overhead is still watching.
12	The Hunters' Code — Hunters keep a code: never abandon a contract, never hunt another Hunter's quarry. Breaking it makes you a target.

3. Skill List

The 20 generic skills are renamed or kept as follows. Default pools are unchanged unless noted.

Sōma	Mētis	Psychē	Pneuma
Athletics	Shoot	Notice	Will
Brawl	Stealth	Investigate	Persuade
Fight	Ride *(was Drive/Pilot)*	Old Lore *(was Lore)*	Intimidate
Endure	Craft	Science *(was Tech)*	Empathy
Frontier *(was Survival)*		Medicine	Occult *(was Arcana)*
		Deceive	

Skill	Covers in this setting
Ride	Horses, cyborg horses, wagons, hover-vehicles, land-ships, and riding through a chase.
Frontier	Wilderness survival, desert and wasteland travel, tracking, mutant animals, weather, finding water.
Old Lore	History, households and bloodlines, etiquette and succession law, charter-speech (§10.5), old-world ruins and records, the folklore of the afflicted.
Science	Repairing, using and disabling machines, old and new; cyborg parts; old-world weapons and works.
Occult	Rites, wards and religious practice; omens, relics and reliquaries; what people believe about the afflicted, and which customs they keep.
Medicine	Surgery, poisons, mutations, blood loss and transfusion (§6).

Guideline: Science and Occult often overlap. Let the player choose which applies, then fix it for that device or effect for the rest of the scene.

4. Day and Night

Time of day is always a scene Truth. Every scene has one.

Time Truth	Effect
Day	Direct sunlight harms vampires and dhampirs (*Sun-Sick*, §7.1). Most vampires keep indoors or underground and many keep night hours, but they are not helpless by day: a vampire in a shuttered room is as dangerous at noon as at midnight. Their retainers, guardians and machines are active.
Dusk	One scene. The GM gains +2 Woe as the sun sets. Vampires come out.
Night	Vampires and dhampirs see in the dark and ignore darkness Truths. Scenes at night with a vampire present add +1 Woe at the start of the scene (dangerous Truth). The GM may use vampire Woe spends (§14).
Dawn	One scene. A vampire in the open must reach shelter or face the sun. At the end of the scene, any vampire still in direct light gains *Sun-Sick* at tier 2 at once, then normally.

Cloud and glass: heavy cloud lessens the harm (§7.1). Experience says sunlight through a window does vampires little harm; no one agrees why.

4.1 The Dawn Clock

When the party must survive until morning, the GM sets a Dawn clock (usually 6 or 8 segments).

- It ticks 1 per scene or 1 per conflict exchange.
- Players may tick it with the Advance effect only by actions that waste time for the enemy (stalling, hiding, leading a chase in circles).
- When it fills, the scene becomes Dawn.

Use the Dawn clock as a racing clock against the vampire's own clock (*Breach the Village 8*, *Take the Girl 6*). Dawn doesn't destroy a vampire; it forces a choice: withdraw, or fight on while the sun takes its toll.

5. Vampires

5.1 Threat Ranks

Rank measures how dangerous a vampire is now — its resources, supply, allies and access to old works — not its age. A vampire who remembers the world before the fall can be any rank; one made last decade can be Paramount.

Rank	Examples	Conflict Disposition bonus	Starting Woe when introduced
Minor	A starving fugitive, a household's newest vampire, a vampire kept as a prisoner	+0	1
Established	Head of a small household, a physician with a private clinic	+2	3
Great	Head of a great house, a vampire whose bloodline opens a town's treatment works	+4	5
Paramount	A founder whose bloodline controls a region	+6	8 (and a danger clock that can end the campaign)

5.2 Hard to Kill

Vampires survive wounds that would kill anyone else.

- A vampire's physical statuses normally stop at tier 5 unless an eligible killing method or an explicit creature-specific rule permits otherwise (§8.1, §7.1). At physical status tier 5 the vampire is *broken*: it can still act, at −2 on physical rolls, unless the status specifies a different outcome. Sun-Sick 5 instead causes collapse and Taken Out; its full-day progression to tier 6 follows §7.1. This protection does not prevent objective-based defeat or cancel an accepted payment; ordinary Disposition loss does not create a physical status.
- Recovery needs blood. A wounded or broken vampire that rests a full day and takes at least half a litre of blood recovers all physical statuses. Without blood, it recovers only 1 tier per day. Status recovery does not restore shared Disposition or undo a settled outcome.
- Wounds make it hungry. Each time a vampire is *broken*, tick its Blood Debt clock (§5.4) by 1.

Killing Strikes

In a scripted conflict, reducing a vampire side's shared Disposition to 0 wins the declared conflict; it does not by itself destroy each vampire on that side. If destroying a particular vampire is within the established lethal stakes, name that vampire and use an eligible killing method against it. Where destruction requires this finishing procedure, victory secures the opportunity to attempt it rather than automatic destruction.

Timing. Complete the deciding volley, including all independent actions, and determine victory or mutual defeat first. Resolve any killing strike the outcome permits before settling compromise. Do not apply a proposed compromise status early solely to reduce the killing-strike Difficulty.

Unless a rule explicitly makes the killing strike automatic, make one killing-strike roll against the named vampire using a fitting skill and eligible method. Set the base Difficulty by the vampire's Rank:

Vampire Rank	Base Difficulty
Minor	Hard 18
Established	Formidable 21
Great	Epic 27
Paramount	Divine 30

Reduce the Difficulty by one step — 3 points — for each tier of the target's highest negative status. Use only the highest tier; do not add different statuses together. There is no minimum Difficulty.

Ability reductions stack. Apply every killing-strike Difficulty reduction whose conditions you meet, in addition to the reduction from the target's highest negative status. Each one-step reduction lowers the target by 3. There is no minimum Difficulty. These reductions do not apply to staking unless an ability explicitly says they do. Bonuses to status tiers or ordinary Disposition loss do not modify a killing strike unless expressly stated.

A success destroys the vampire. On a failure, it is not destroyed: the GM states a significant complication that fits the stakes, such as escape, a rescue attempt or a dangerous reversal. The players may give the GM 2 Woe to buy off that complication. Buying off the complication does not turn the failed strike into a success.

Resolve the established conflict outcome and compromise separately. A failed killing strike does not automatically impose a Significant compromise, reopen the original conflict or reset Disposition.

Automatic killing strikes. An automatic killing strike requires no roll and uses only the outcome specified by its rule. Do not calculate killing-strike Difficulty or apply Difficulty reductions, and do not use the failed-strike complication or its 2-Woe buy-off. Full-day direct-sun exposure against a vampire follows §7.1. Automatic destruction grants no additional action, restores no Disposition, erases no compromise cost and does not reopen a settled conflict outcome.

Beheading follows this procedure. There is no separate beheading difficulty table or tier-4+ status prerequisite. Staking remains a separate special case (§8.1).

5.3 Vampire Traits

Each vampire has 3–5 power tags and at least 1 weakness tag, for example: *the old hospital opens for me*, *a hundred donors*, *remembers the founding*, *faster than you can see*, *sees perfectly in the dark*; and *starving*, *the doors don't know me*, *obsessed with the past*, *proud beyond reason*, *my supply runs through one man*, *believes the old stories* (§8.1). Players can learn them with Discover.

Pride: the long-lived are proud. Once per scene, a PC may compel a vampire's pride (spend 1 Tychē Point or 1 Momentum): it accepts a duel, gives a warning before striking, or lets an insult distract it. The GM gains 1 Woe.

5.4 Blood Debt

Every vampire needs blood regularly. The GM tracks each vampire NPC's hunger on a Blood Debt clock of 6 segments, one segment per week since its last full feeding.

Segments	What the players can see
0–1	Nothing.
2–3	Pallor, irritability, an unusual interest in blood (Notice, Empathy).
4	Pain, slowness, gifts failing: −1 on all its rolls. It takes risks to feed.
5	Desperate: −2 on all its rolls. Survival comes first; it may break its own rules.
6	Husk: the vampire dries out and goes dormant (§5.5).

- Being *broken* ticks the clock (§5.2). A full feeding clears it. A partial feeding stops it ticking that week but doesn't clear it.
- Animal blood counts for half: a vampire needs twice as much of it.

5.5 Husks

Sometimes a starved vampire is found dried, light and rigid, like a corpse a century dead. Stories say such bodies can wake. Stories also say they burn like kindling.

- A husk is unconscious and helpless. Any killing strike against it succeeds automatically, and fire destroys it at once. These specific finishing exceptions do not grant an extra scripted action or destroy other participants on its side.
- Waking one takes about three people's worth of blood, absorbed over hours or days. It wakes at Blood Debt 5.

5.6 The Returned

Not everyone the Kept try to make becomes one of them. The making is dangerous and often fails, and most who fail die. A few survive as something else: the returned.

- What people see: the returned are strong and grow fast, and most die young, rarely past thirty. Many are slow, literal or strange in their thinking; how much varies. They don't need blood.
- Not dhampirs: folk often call them dhampirs, or cursed. They are neither. Dhampirs are born to vampire mothers (*Carries Her Mother's Blood*); the returned were made, and the making failed.
- Evidence: old-world doors and instruments sometimes react to one of the returned oddly, as if it half-belonged to a bloodline. No one agrees why. Households that make them would rather no one asked.
- Levies: some towns owe children under old charters. Rumour says the few who come back are the ones who failed.
- NPCs only: the returned are not a player option. A PC who survives a failed making leaves player control (§6).

6. The Bled

When a vampire feeds on someone — or anyone loses a great deal of blood — the victim gains the harmful status *Bled*. Bled is a physical injury caused by blood loss, not depletion or a supernatural affliction. Resist with Sōma when the blood is taken, unless the Bled is an accepted payment.

Bled tier	Effect
1	A donation's worth. Pale and tired. No roll penalty; clears after a full night's safe rest with food and water.
2	Light-headed: −1 on Sōma and Mētis rolls.
3	Weak: −2 on Sōma and Mētis rolls, and gain *Weary*.
4	Critical blood loss: −4 on Sōma and Mētis rolls. Further blood loss stacks normally; unrelated harm does not automatically Take you Out.
5	Severe blood loss: −5 on Sōma and Mētis rolls. This tier alone does not make you Dying or impose a death deadline.
6	Drained: Taken Out and gain a Scar under Core Rules §6.3. If lethal stakes allow, start the core three-segment Dying clock (§6.7); reaching this tier does not cause immediate death.

Penalty exception. Bled's listed roll penalties replace the normal penalty equal to status tier; do not apply both. Bled hinders physical activity using Sōma or Mētis within that scope. Bled retains the core tier-6 Scar procedure, including its limits against duplicate Scars.

- Gaining tiers: a measured feeding inflicts Bled-1. A hard feeding is an Attack (+2 or more). Stacking rules apply. Ordinary conflict Attacks do not inflict Bled merely because their narration includes a bite; an explicit effect must grant the status.
- Recovery: pools and Bled recover separately. Restoring pools does not remove Bled. Once further blood loss has stopped, Bled-1 clears after a full night's safe rest with food and water. At tiers 2–5, appropriate care and a full day of safe rest with food and water remove one tier. These intervals replace the core injury-healing intervals for Bled. At tier 6, definitive care is required before natural recovery begins.
- Dying from Bled: only Bled reaching tier 6 can make you Dying. Use Core Rules §6.7 for the Dying clock, stabilisation, further harm and definitive care; there is no separate scene-end death deadline. Stabilising stops the clock but does not lower Bled, restore pools or return you to ordinary action.
- Transfusion: with a willing donor and a transfusion kit, a Medicine roll vs. Standard 15 lowers Bled by 1 tier per Power. The donor gains Bled-1 as an accepted payment; prevention, reduction, redirection, Resistance and incidental clearing benefits cannot cancel it. Once recorded, it recovers normally. This is an explicit exception to the ordinary one-tier injury-treatment limit and its *treated* restriction: a treated Bled injury can still benefit from transfusion. At Bled-6, suitable transfusion can provide definitive care under Core Rules §6.7. When it lowers Bled below tier 6 and removes the immediate lethal cause, clear the Dying clock. It does not restore pools or erase a Scar.
- Frontier law: where optional Truth 8 is in play, anyone known to be bled is examined, confined or exiled. Hiding the marks is a common compel.
- A PC who is Drained and made a vampire, or who survives a failed making as one of the returned (§5.6), leaves player control.

7. Afflicted Blood: Sunlight Syndrome and the Thirst

These rules apply to vampires and dhampirs (*Carries Her Mother's Blood*).

7.1 Sunlight Syndrome

Under the Day Truth, in direct sunlight, the afflicted gain *Sun-Sick*:

Condition	Dhampirs	Vampires
Direct sun, at the start of each scene	+1	+2
Merciless Sun (deserts, harsh sun)	+2	+3
Heavy overcast, per scene	+0	+1
Sunlit room or *False Dawn* (§13), per exchange	+1	+1

- Sun-Sick is a harmful status: it applies its tier as a penalty to physical rolls (Sōma and Mētis skills).
- Resist with Sōma as normal. A wide hat, a dark cloak or partial shade counts as +1 Sōma Edge for that Resist.

- While Sun-Sick is at tier 1+, abilities and rules that heal the afflicted (vampire recovery, *Mother's Blood*, *Dhampir Regeneration*) don't work.
- A vampire at Sun-Sick 4+ also gains *burning-1* each scene in the sun.
- Recovery: a full scene in shade or darkness lowers Sun-Sick by 2 tiers. At night it clears completely.
- Normal cap: Sun-Sick cannot rise above tier 5 through ordinary gains or stacking. Only the full-day exposure procedure below advances it to tier 6.
- Tier 5: collapse. Taken Out until carried into shade. Tier-5 collapse alone does not grant a Scar or start a Dying clock.

Full-day Exposure and Sun-Sick 6

A dhampir at Sun-Sick 5 who is left in the sun for a full day advances to Sun-Sick 6 and remains Taken Out. Record one Sōma Scar under Core Rules §6.3, subject to its episode and event limits. This is the normal Scar for reaching tier 6, not an additional Scar for becoming Dying.

If established lethal stakes permit, this is life-threatening physical harm: start the core three-segment Dying clock and follow Core Rules §6.7. Otherwise, apply incapacitation and the Scar without starting a Dying clock.

Rescue and stabilisation. For a dhampir Dying from Sun-Sick, removal from harmful sunlight stabilises them and stops the Dying clock. This does not erase marked segments, lower Sun-Sick or return them to ordinary action.

Definitive care. A full scene in shade or darkness lowers Sun-Sick by 2 tiers as normal; at night it clears completely. When this recovery lowers Sun-Sick below tier 6 and harmful exposure has ended, it counts as definitive care for this condition: clear the sunlight-caused Dying clock.

Stabilising the dhampir, lowering or clearing Sun-Sick, and clearing the Dying clock do not remove the Sōma Scar. Repeated exposure during the same episode follows the core Scar Recorded rules.

If renewed exposure makes the dhampir Dying again before that clock has been cleared, resume it from its recorded segments. Apply the core rules for further harm; ordinary Sun-Sick gains still cannot advance the status above tier 5.

Vampires. Full-day exposure to direct sunlight is a killing method against vampires. A vampire at Sun-Sick 5 who is left in direct sun for a full day advances to Sun-Sick 6 and suffers an automatic killing strike: it is destroyed without a roll. Do not start a Dying clock.

Separate consequences. These sunlight-specific stabilisation and recovery rules do not stabilise or clear a Dying clock caused by a separate injury. A separate harmful status, such as burning, follows its own core consequences and Scar limits. Recovering from Sun-Sick does not restore pools or shared Disposition, erase Scars or undo a settled conflict outcome.

7.2 The Thirst

Dhampirs have a Thirst status, tier 0–6. It doesn't penalise rolls until tier 3. A dhampir has no weekly need for blood; the Thirst rises only from what happens to them.

Trigger	Thirst
A scene with fresh blood spilled nearby (yours or someone else's)	+1
You're Taken Out, or a pool drops to 2 or less	+1
You use an ability marked *Thirst* in its entry	+1 (or as listed)
The GM compels the Thirst and you accept (gain a Tychē Point)	+1
A full night of rest	−1
Animal blood (a scene, no roll)	−1
A cup or so of human blood — drunk, through broken skin or by transfusion (a scene, no roll)	−2
Half a litre or more of human blood at once	Clear completely. If taken by force, gain a Pneuma Scar the first time (*I've tasted it*)

Thirst tier	Effect
0–2	No effect.
3–4	−1 on Pneuma rolls when blood is visible. Others notice you're hungry (Empathy, Notice).
5	In every scene with a bleeding human, Resist with Pneuma or move towards them.
6	Blood Crisis: you choose — feed from the nearest source this scene, or refuse, collapse (Taken Out) and gain a Pneuma Scar. Either way, Thirst drops to 3 afterwards.

Specific breaking-point rule. Thirst uses Blood Crisis and its listed Scar consequences instead of the generic tier-6 Scar trigger. Reaching Thirst 6 does not itself add a Scar or Take you Out before you make the Blood Crisis choice. Feeding does not grant an unstated tier-6 Scar; the separately listed first forced-feeding Scar still applies when its condition is met. Refusing grants the listed Pneuma Scar, not a duplicate generic Scar. Apply core limits against duplicate Scars from one event. Lowering Thirst does not restore shared Disposition, reopen a settled outcome or erase a recorded Scar.

Never feeding is a Belief, not a rule. Blood Crisis keeps the choice, and the cost of refusing, with the player.

8. How the Afflicted Die, and Hunter's Gear

8.1 Killing Methods and Folklore

A killing method establishes how a vampire can be destroyed. It does not make an ordinary conflict Attack inflict a status. Resolve killing strikes, including beheading, under §5.2. Staking follows its separate procedure below.

Method	Effect	Notes
Beheading	Killing method; use §5.2	The blade must be able to cut through (*heavy*, *fine*, or sufficient strength). No tier-4+ status prerequisite.
Fire (sustained)	Killing method against a vampire *broken* at physical status tier 5; destroys a husk at once	A burning house, a funeral pyre. Reaching 0 shared Disposition does not itself make a vampire broken.
Sunlight	No killing strike, but stops recovery and burns over time (§7.1)	A collapsed vampire left in direct sun for a full day is destroyed.
Stake through the heart	Not a killing method. Inflicts the special condition *staked*: the vampire can't act or recover while the stake stays in	Use the Staking procedure below. Finish it with beheading or fire — or bargain with it while it's helpless.
Silver	Not a killing method. Wounds from *silvered* weapons can't be recovered until the next full day	An old custom. No one remembers why it works.
Crosses, garlic, running water, invitations	No physical effect	Folk practice. Some vampires believe in them anyway (below).

Believers: a vampire may carry the weakness tag *believes the old stories*, or a specific one (*won't cross running water*, *can't bear the cross*). Against that vampire, the folk remedy works as a compel, not a law of nature: the vampire accepts it (the GM gains 1 Woe) or the GM spends 1 Woe to defy it.

Any personal weakness tag of a vampire can be upgraded to a killing method with 3 Power from Discover and Create effects, or a downtime clock (8 segments).

Staking

A stake through the heart does not destroy a vampire. It pins the vampire in a helpless state until someone removes it.

Making the attempt. You need a wooden stake or a weapon explicitly capable of driving one through the heart, and a clear opportunity to reach it. A weapon's ordinary Attack bonus does not, by itself, grant permission to stake at range.

Declare the attempt before rolling. Use Fight or Brawl in reach, or Shoot with a weapon explicitly capable of delivering a stake at range.

Set the base Difficulty by the vampire's Rank:

Vampire Rank	Base Difficulty
Minor	Hard 18
Established	Formidable 21
Great	Epic 27
Paramount	Divine 30

Reduce the Difficulty by one step — 3 points — for each tier of the vampire's highest negative status. Use only the highest tier; do not add statuses together. There is no minimum Difficulty.

Result. On a Success or Success at a Cost, the vampire gains *staked*. This is a special condition, not a tiered status: do not buy its tiers with Power or stack it with other statuses.

While staked, the vampire cannot act or recover. It remains alive. Staking does not itself inflict tier-6 harm, trigger a killing strike, or destroy the vampire.

On a Success at a Cost, apply the normal cost as well as the successful staking. On a failure, the stake does not take hold; resolve failure normally.

Staking during a conflict. A staking attempt uses your scripted Attack action. Resolve its roll against the staking Difficulty instead of the usual independent or versus roll. It inflicts *staked* instead of ordinary Attack Disposition loss.

Staking one vampire does not directly reduce its side's shared Disposition. If other participants can continue pursuing that side's intent, the conflict continues. If none can, resolve that side's defeat normally.

Removing the stake. Another character within reach can remove the stake if they have the means to do so. With no meaningful opposition or uncertainty, no roll is needed. Under pressure, removing it takes an action and any roll the circumstances require.

Once the stake is removed, *staked* ends. The vampire retains its other statuses, Blood Debt and other recorded conditions. Removing a stake does not refill pools, restore Disposition or undo a settled conflict outcome.

8.2 Currency and Wealth

The setting's currency is the mark. The 2d12 System doesn't track coins; use these story tags instead:

Wealth tag	Means
broke	Can't buy anything without a favour or a trade
a few marks	A meal, a night at the inn, a box of bolts
a fat purse	A horse, a gun, a doctor's fee
a lord's bounty	A cyborg horse, an old-world weapon, a farm

8.3 Setting Gear

Weapons and gear use the equipment rules in *Generic Playbooks* §2 (load, gear as tags, armour). These are common across playbooks:

Load	Item	Tags
0	Wooden stake, belt knife, flint striker, water skin	*stake* (use the Staking procedure, §8.1)
1	Silver-edged knife or blade	*silvered*
1	Charms: garlic bundle, cross, saint's medal	*steadies the nerves* (+1 Pneuma Edge against fear); works on *believers* only (§8.1)
1	Steel neck guard	*Armour 1* against bites only; Bled from bites gains 1 fewer tier
1	Crossbow and wooden bolts	*+1 Attack* (range), *bolts are stakes* (may stake at range using Shoot; use §8.1 instead of a fixed Hard 18)
1	Revolver or rifle	*+1 Attack* (range)
2	Laser rifle (rare, old-world)	*+1 Attack* (range), *burns through armour*, *Escalation*; depletion 1 in d12 (power cell)
1	Long cloak and wide hat	+1 Sōma Edge when Resisting Sun-Sick; *+1 Feint* in the dark
1	Signal mirrors	By day, create *Sunlit* in a room with a window or opening for one scene (2 Power)
1	True-light lamp (rare relic)	Create *False Dawn* for one exchange (2 Power); depletion 1 in d12
1	Flares	Light only; ends darkness Truths for one exchange
1	Transfusion kit	Needed for transfusion (§6); *+1* on Medicine against Bled
0	Cyborg horse (vehicle)	*tireless*, *fast as the wind*; not on foot missions. Treat as a story tag when absent
0	Normal horse or mule (vehicle)	*sure-footed*; ticks the Grind clock 1 less per leg

Escalation (Core Rules §9.3). Each of these gives the GM +1 Woe, once per scene:

- Old-world weapons carried openly: the laser rifle, the *Order Sidearm* (§9.2), any artifact weapon.
- Hunter's tools carried openly where a vampire rules (*Their Own House*, §13, or a town that serves a household): stakes, silver, crossbows.
- Actions: waking an old-world work you don't understand; breaking into a sealed estate room; feeding, or showing afflicted blood, before witnesses.

9. Old-World Works

Old-world machines and relics use Module A — Cyphers & Artifacts.

9.1 Old-World Cyphers (d12)

d12	Cypher	Tier	Effect
1	True-light capsule	4	Attack (*Sun-Sick* +2) against one vampire; a killing method only against a husk
2	Blood ampoule	3	Restore 3 Sōma; a dhampir also loses 2 Thirst
3	Mist grenade	3	Create *Thick Mist* for a scene
4	Gravity disc	4	Create *Weightless* in a small area, or carry a heavy load as light
5	Mind-seal patch	3	Restore (fear); +1 to Resist intimidation and *Presence* (§14)
6	Bloodline vial	2	A vial of a vampire's blood: opens one door of its bloodline, or quiets one of its guardians for a scene
7	Holo-ghost	3	Create *Decoy* (a false image of yourself) for a scene
8	Electro-whip charge	4	Attack (*stunned*), or +1 Attack in a conflict for one exchange
9	Healing gel	3	Restore (wounds) 3 tiers, divided as you like
10	Weather pill	4	Create a weather Truth (*Sudden Storm*, *Clear Skies*) for one scene
11	Sound blaster	3	Attack (*deafened*), Disrupt one Occult effect
12	Unknown relic	d6	The player names a reasonable Effect; the GM sets the form and adds a quirk

9.2 Old-World Artifacts

The Order of the Last Guns (working name) was an order of armed charter-enforcers in a neighbouring province, destroyed there in a succession war. The Frontier sees only what it left behind: refugees, claimants and a few of its sidearms, which no one can make any more. Whoever carries one claims to speak for the old enforcing authority.

Old-world artifacts carry the standard quirk *its owners will want it back*: it can be compelled for Tychē Points, and the GM may spend 1 Woe to make its old owners, or their heirs, notice it.

★ *Old-World Longsword* — Tags: *old-world steel, +1 Attack (conflict gear).* Ability: *counts as a killing method for beheading; ignores* Armour *on vampires.* Depletion: *none.* Quirk: *its owners will want it back.*

★ *Dimension Pocket* — Tags: *holds more than it should.* Ability: *carry up to 3 extra load. Once per session, draw out an item you could plausibly have stored (no Momentum cost).* Depletion: *1 in d12 (it opens somewhere else for a scene).* Quirk: *things inside come out wrong.*

★ *Cybernetic Eye* — Tags: *sees in the dark, sees heat.* Ability: *once per scene, free Discover about anything in your line of sight.* Depletion: *1 in d12 (blind in that eye for a scene).* Quirk: *its owners will want it back.*

★ *Order Sidearm* — Tags: *old-world revolver, +1 Attack (range), recognised on sight, Escalation.* Ability: *ignores* Armour *on vampires. Worn openly, it is a claim to speak for the Order of the Last Guns: a free bonus die on Persuade and Intimidate with people who remember the Order.* Locked: *many fire only for someone registered in the Order's armoury log; for anyone else such a gun is a heavy club.* Depletion: *1 in d12 (the last proper cartridges are spent until more are found).* Quirk: *its owners will want it back — and so will every claimant.*

Blood Locket — Tags: *holds a vampire's blood.* Ability: *that bloodline's doors and guardians half-recognise you (+1 die).* Depletion: *1 in d12 (the blood spoils).* Quirk: *the bloodline's records note every door you open.*

9.3 The Moving Lights

On a clear night, a few lights cross the sky faster than any star and never twinkle. They are old-world works, left overhead when the old world fell. Most are dead. A few still answer.

- Under open sky only: roofs, earth, deep canyons, thick forest and storms (*Sudden Storm*) cut them off.
- Uses: the Passenger can reach its bearer through them (*Carries a Passenger*), and a mind sent abroad can ride them (*Sends the Mind Abroad*). Some households keep old instruments that listen to them.
- Overheard: anything sent through the moving lights may be heard by whoever is listening.
- Optional Truth 11 (§2.2, *The lights in the sky still move*): if it is in play, something up there is also watching.

10. Bounties, Commissions and Contracts

Most sessions start with a contract. The contract is the party's shared Goal. A contract is a Bounty (a quarry), a Commission (an investigation), an Escort or a Recovery.

10.1 Contract Sheet

Element	Example
Type	Bounty
Client	The town council, on behalf of a farmer whose daughter was fed on
Quarry	Lord Varn, a vampire (rank: Established)
Proof required	His head, his blood ledger, or his signet ring
Bounty	*a lord's bounty* (a Great vampire: two)
Deadline	Before the levy is collected (danger clock, 6 segments)
Complication	Lord Varn insists he hasn't fed in five weeks — and a rival Hunter crew has the same contract

10.2 Negotiating the Fee

Haggling with a client is a Negotiation conflict if it meets the conflict test (Core Rules §10.1); otherwise one Persuade roll vs. Standard 15.

- Each Power above 1 raises the fee by one step (*a fat purse* → *a lord's bounty*), or adds a perk (an advance, a horse, room and board, a share of the estate's salvage).
- A dhampir negotiating with humans faces the Truth *Feared and Despised* (+1 step Difficulty), unless they're already known and trusted. With a vampire household, they may face *Coveted* instead (§13).

10.3 Reputation

A Hunter's reputation is a power tag gained at milestones (*the Hunter who burned the Roth estate*). It counts as a tag on Persuade and Intimidate with Frontier folk. A bad reputation (*took the money and ran*) is a weakness tag that clients and rivals compel.

10.4 Rival Hunters

Rival crews use the World Turn rules (Module E.10 when Module E is in use; otherwise Module C.5) with a project clock on the same quarry. With Modules D and E, resolve one World Turn per stay. If their clock fills first, they claim the bounty, and the party's contract becomes a Disposition conflict with the rivals (often a Negotiation or a Chase rather than a Fight).

10.5 Charter-Speech and Binding Instruments

Charters, testaments, compacts and levy agreements bind only if they are written or sworn in charter-speech: an archaic legal and liturgical form of the language. Notaries, clergy and record clerks can compose it, and so can some of the Kept. Most people can only recognise it.

- Reading an instrument in charter-speech is an Old Lore roll vs. Standard 15. Composing one correctly is Old Lore vs. Hard 18, or Standard 15 with a tag such as *fluent in the old pacts*.
- Finding a flaw: a Discover effect on an instrument (Old Lore or Investigate) can reveal an error in its charter-speech. The flaw becomes a tag, for example *the oath was sworn in the wrong form*.
- Grounds, not a verdict: a flaw is grounds to challenge the instrument. It does not void it. The challenge is settled by a Negotiation, a Duel of Wills or the politics around it, and the flaw is a tag the challenger can use there. Whoever benefits from the instrument will argue that the error doesn't matter.

10.6 Ill Omens

A crow on the steeple, a stopped clock, a dog that won't cross the threshold. Once per contract, one player may declare an Ill Omen and describe it. The GM gains 2 Woe + 1 per PC at once; at the end of the scene, every PC gains 1 Tychē Point (within the cap, Core Rules §4.1). Reading an omen is an Occult roll, with Power buying Discover as normal. An omen is a warning, not a prophecy.

11. Setting Conflict Types

These add to the conflict types in Core Rules §10.4. All use the standard scripting, Disposition and compromise rules.

Type	Disposition	Attack	Defend	Feint	Maneuver
Hunt (track a vampire or monster to its lair)	Frontier or Investigate	Investigate / Frontier	Will / Endure	Deceive	Notice / Stealth
Siege Until Dawn (hold a town or camp until morning)	Old Lore (tactics) or Craft	Shoot / Fight	Craft / Endure	Deceive	Notice
Duel of Wills (an interrogation, an audience, a stare-down with something old and patient)	Will	Intimidate / Persuade	Will	Deceive	Empathy
Estate Assault (break into a household or old-world facility)	Science or Stealth	Science / Fight	Endure / Athletics	Stealth	Old Lore
Chase (setting note)	Ride or Athletics	Ride / Shoot	Ride	Stealth	Frontier

11.1 Special Rules

- Hunt: the winner gets their intent *and* chooses the time of the confrontation (day or night). If the party wins with the quarry's lair found by day, the next scene starts with Day, and the quarry is shut in, away from the sun.
- Siege Until Dawn: run alongside the Dawn clock (§4.1). Each exchange ticks it by 1. If the Dawn clock fills before either side hits 0 Disposition, the vampire side must withdraw or face the sun: the defenders win with a compromise based on their remaining Disposition.
- Duel of Wills: there is no hypnosis; this is pressure, fear and bargaining. A PC who loses is Taken Out of the contest and must follow the vampire's intent for one scene, out of obligation, fear or a bargain struck. A vampire who loses withdraws or reveals something (lose 1 power tag for the session).
- Estate Assault: each exchange, the GM may spend 1 Woe to wake a guardian (reinforcement) instead of buying a bonus die. If an estate is taken by day, its vampire's Disposition in the next Fight starts −2.

12. The Frontier: Travel and Region Truths

Use Module B — The Grind & Travel. The Frontier is harsh: most Grind clocks are 6; deserts and old-poisoned lands are 4.

12.1 Frontier Travel Notes

- The Guide rolls Ride or Frontier.
- Cyborg horses don't eat or tire: a party with them ignores the first Grind tick each leg. Normal horses need water: Supplies drop by 2 per leg in deserts.
- Night travel halves Grind clock size, but every encounter is at Night.

12.2 Frontier Truth Generator (d12)

Use with Module C.3. Roll once per column or pick.

d12	Terrain / Feature	Atmosphere	Hazard	Secret
1	Fortified farming town	Sullen, watching faces	Townsfolk with torches	Someone in town is secretly feeding a vampire
2	Vampire estate on a crag	Silent music at midnight	Guardian machines	The vampire wants to die
3	Endless desert	Merciless sun	Sand creatures under the dunes	A buried old-world city
4	Ruined old-world city	Wind through dead towers	Radiation pockets	An old-world weapon
5	Haunted forest	Mist that never lifts	Mutant beasts	A retainer-clan camp
6	Trading post and saloon	Whiskey and fear	Rival Hunters	A household's spy runs the bar
7	Swamp of failed experiments	Wet, rotting heat	Bioweapon remnants	A creature that can speak
8	Abandoned treatment works	Lights still on	Automated defences	Records of the original treatment, maybe
9	Dry riverbed and canyon	Dust storms	Bandits on cyborg horses	A water source someone poisoned
10	Mountain pass	Biting cold	Avalanche	A monk who remembers the founding
11	Weather-control tower	Storms that come out of nowhere	Lightning	The tower still answers orders
12	Graveyard of Hunters	Unnatural stillness	A husk among the graves	A famous Hunter didn't die here

13. Scene Truths

Pick 1–3 for each scene, in addition to the time Truth (§4).

Truth	Typical effect
Moonlit	Stealth is harder for everyone; vampires and dhampirs see clearly
Moonless	+1 step Difficulty to Notice; vampires and dhampirs ignore it
Merciless Sun	Sun-Sick +2 per scene for dhampirs, +3 for vampires (§7.1)
Overcast	Sun-Sick +1 per scene for vampires; none for dhampirs
Sunlit	Direct sun indoors (mirrors, a broken roof): Sun-Sick +1 per exchange
Warded Village	The townsfolk believe they're safe. Believers (§8.1) won't cross without defying a compel; everyone else finds the townsfolk armed and watching (+1 step Difficulty to Stealth)
Custom of Invitation	Entering a home uninvited breaks local custom: if seen, the scene gains *Hostile Crowd*. Believers must defy a compel
Their Own House	Inside a place that answers to the vampire's bloodline: its Woe spends cost 1 less (minimum 1)
Frightened Villagers	+1 step Difficulty to Persuade; failures may start a mob
Feared and Despised	Dhampirs and mutants: +1 step Difficulty to all social rolls with humans
Coveted	A dhampir among a vampire household: social rolls are one step easier, but every success puts them further in the household's debt
Thick Mist	+1 step Difficulty to Shoot and Notice
Guardian Machines	A danger clock of 4: when it fills, the guardians attack
Blood on the Air	Thirst +1 for dhampirs; a vampire at Blood Debt 3+ must act on it or take −1
False Dawn	True-light lamps: vampires gain Sun-Sick +1 per exchange, can't recover, and take −1 on all rolls (lasts one exchange or scene)
Dust Storm	+1 step Difficulty to Ride, Shoot and Notice
Hostile Crowd	Standard Truth: social rolls harder, violence draws a mob

Any of these can be rank 2 when the fiction is severe (*Dust Storm 2* in a full blow, *Thick Mist 2* in the river bottoms; Core Rules §8).

14. Woe Spends: Vampires

Use with Core Rules §9.2.

GM spend	Cost	Effect
Presence	1	A PC facing the vampire takes *shaken-2* (Resist with Pneuma). Start a Duel of Wills if it matters
Summon the Household	1	A retainer, donor or dependant arrives and obeys — out of loyalty, debt, love or fear
The Old Door	2	The vampire leaves through a way only its bloodline can open, or a passage nobody knew was there
Kennel and Guardians	2	Trained animals, mutant creatures or old-world guardians that answer to it arrive as a minion group
Uncanny Speed	1	The vampire acts first or changes its scripted action for 1 Woe (instead of 3). Not at Blood Debt 4+
The House Answers	3	Requires *Their Own House*. Create a facility Truth (*Shifting Halls*, *Sealed Doors*, *Lights Fail*, *Gravity Fails*)
Blood Reserve	3	Once per session, if blood is at hand (stored, a donor, a victim), a *broken* vampire feeds and recovers 2 tiers of physical status. It leaves evidence
Weather Turns	2	Create a weather Truth for the scene; requires old weather works nearby
Retainer	3	A significant retainer or ally arrives

15. Design Notes

- Hard to Kill (§5.2) keeps the two-stage fight — wear it down, then a killing strike — but ties recovery to blood. Wounding a vampire makes it hungrier, and a hungry vampire is a different problem. Watch how long this makes fights; if too long, allow the killing strike as part of the final Attack instead of a separate roll.
- The Bled and the Thirst are both statuses, so the existing Restore, Resist and compel rules work on them. Bled is plain blood loss; its tier 6 is death, with one ominous exception.
- Day and night no longer switch vampires on and off. Sunlight is a cost, not a cage; the daytime advantage comes from finding where a vampire is and getting light in.
- Folklore works through belief, not physics. The *believer* rule lets old remedies matter at the table without becoming true.
- Sunlight Syndrome still limits dhampirs by day, when the rest of the party is strongest. That trade is the core of the dhampir's role.
- Science vs. Occult: keep the line blurred on purpose. The guideline in §3 stops arguments without forcing a fixed answer.
- Contracts as Goals give the party a shared Goal each session, and personal Goals sit inside it.
- The returned (§5.6) are NPCs only. They give failed makings a face and a body of evidence without adding a second dhampir option.
- Charter-speech (§10.5) gives Old Lore a political edge: a flawed oath opens a dispute rather than ending one.

16. Frontier Adversaries

Use the core Adversaries chapter for Rank, Role, ordinary Human/Beast/Guardian packages, encounter preparation, shared Disposition, scripting, rotation, Boss Phases and the common Special procedures. This section supplies the Frontier-specific construction exceptions and entries relocated from core. It adds no new action, phase permission, discount or Special slot.

References to *Core Adversaries* point to that chapter in The 2d12 System, not to a section of Frontier Rules. Last Stand and Fail-safe retain their separate core procedures (§§6.10–6.11); a deferred setting Special uses Core Adversaries §6.12 only when its entry explicitly says so.

16.1 Vampire Construction Exceptions

Use the following values when constructing an ordinary vampire adversary with the core card. Ratings, Guard, Shrugs, Roles and Special limits still follow core Rank. These allowances relocate the vampire exceptions; they are not additional bonuses to apply on top of the card.

Rank	Grit = Threat	Power / weakness tags	Introduction Woe
Minor	3	3 / 1	1
Established	5	4 / 1	3
Great	8	5 / 2	5
Paramount	12	5 / 2	8

Vampire Grit already includes the Threat Rank Disposition bonus (+0 / +2 / +4 / +6) in Frontier Rules §5.1. Do not add it again. Grit contributes to the side's shared starting Disposition; it is not a personal track. Introduction Woe is paid once, the first time the vampire appears in the campaign, not again for each encounter or new source fragment.

The construction table makes the inherited Rank-based tag allowances explicit; it does not add tags beyond them. Frontier Rules §5.3 supplies tag examples and the Pride procedure. Apply that procedure, Blood Debt (§5.4), killing methods (§8.1) and Sunlight Syndrome (§7.1) only in their stated scopes.

16.2 Vampire Kind Package

- Hard to Kill. Physical statuses stop at tier 5 without a killing method. Tier 5 is broken (−2 on physical rolls).
- Blood Debt. −1 to all ratings at 4 segments, −2 at 5. Being broken ticks the clock.
- Pride, Sun-Sick and killing methods all apply.
- Killing strike. A vampire side at 0 shared Disposition is defeated, not automatically wounded or destroyed. Name an eligible vampire and follow Frontier Rules §5.2, within the established lethal stakes; shared Disposition loss grants no physical status. Complete independent actions, determine victory or mutual defeat, resolve any permitted finishing procedure, then settle compromise (Core Rules §10.12).
- Introduction Woe, paid once, the first time it appears in the campaign: Minor 1, Established 3, Great 5, Paramount 8.
- Woe Spends (Presence, Uncanny Speed, Summon the Household) are open to every vampire and do not count against Specials.

Special	Woe	Effect
Feed	1	After it wins a versus Attack in melee against a PC, record one deferred Bled-2 application against that PC (Core Adversaries §6.12). Outside conflicts, Bled-2 on the hit. It recovers 1 tier of physical status when used, not at deferred settlement.
Unnatural Strength	1	+1 Power on a successful Attack. Outside conflicts, +2 tiers.
Terrible Patience	1	Ignore one status or Blood Debt penalty for one roll.
Fade	2	Create the Truth Deep Shadows. It may be gone when the light returns.
Blood Price	3	Paramount only. Tick the campaign danger clock by 1 and restore 3 of its side's shared Disposition (up to the side's starting value).

16.3 Retainer-Clan Options

A retainer-clan adversary uses the core Human package and may select the following Specials within its normal Rank limit. These options do not replace Human Morale or grant Fanatic for free. A designated phased boss still follows the core phase-allocation and availability rules.

Special	Woe	Effect
Shadow-meld	0	Retainer clan, once per scene. Step between shadows. May swap one revealed action for a Maneuver.
Beast Form	1	Retainer clan. Attack becomes Best for the scene, and it gains the Beast package.

Shadow-meld expressly permits changing a revealed action but does not permit actor reassignment, undoing resolved effects or cancelling independent actions retroactively. Beast Form retains its listed 1-Woe cost, scene duration and Beast package; the core fixed-category Desperate bonus does not move merely because this Special changes a rating.

16.4 Using the Core Templates on the Frontier

The core Knife in the Dark can represent a retainer-clan human; its listed Dirty Trick, ratings, Grit and other mechanics do not change. Select additional clan options only through normal construction, not as free additions to the template. The Bounty Veteran's reputation tag may be described as *a name the Kept know* on the Frontier; this reskins its listed reputation tag rather than adding another tag or bonus.

CHAPTER III

Frontier Descriptors

Twenty adjectives for people hardened by the Frontier: the Bitten, the Coveted, the Frontier-Hard, the Vengeful. Each comes with a Frontier hook, one question about your past that often becomes your first Belief.

The adjective of the character sentence.

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1. Descriptor Rules

Each Descriptor gives (Core Rules §3.1):

Element	Detail
Pool bonus	+2 to one pool
Power tag	1
Weakness tag	1 (can be compelled for Tychē Points)
Suggested Instinct	Use it or write your own

Each entry also has a Frontier hook: one question to answer at character creation. The answer often becomes your first Belief or a relationship.

Descriptions are not extra mechanics. A Descriptor grants its listed benefits, not unstated immunities or outcomes. *Scarred* does not itself record a mechanical Scar toward retirement. *Doomed* does not authorise death without established lethal stakes. Descriptive tags do not automatically inflict statuses, change Disposition or override creature-specific finishing procedures.

1.1 Hidden Truths

Some Frontier pasts are better kept quiet: marks on a throat, a mother nobody named, years served in a household. At creation, you may mark one tag from your Descriptor, Focus or playbook as a Hidden Truth, agreed privately with the GM.

- While it's hidden: +1 Refresh. This doesn't count toward the advancement Refresh limit (Core Rules §12.2). The tag gives no bonus and can't be invoked or compelled. If you use an ability tied to it where others can see, the GM may treat that as revealing it.
- Revealing it: reveal it yourself in a scene where it matters. You lose the +1 Refresh, gain 1 Tychē Point at once, and the tag works normally from then on.
- Forced into the open: another character can uncover it with a Discover effect, or the GM can spend 2 Woe to reveal it at a dramatic moment. You still gain the Tychē Point.
- Good candidates: *Bitten*, *Coveted* and *Doomed* (Descriptors); *Carries Her Mother's Blood* with an unknown mother, *Was Kept and Got Out* and *Once Served a Household* (Focuses).

Who learns it. When a secret is revealed, establish who learns it and how. A revelation changes what those characters know going forward; it does not retroactively cancel a resolved action, injury, Disposition loss, accepted payment or settled outcome. Discovering a secret during a conflict does not recalculate Superiority after setup or by itself award an unrelated conflict objective.

2. Quick Reference

#	Descriptor	Pool	Power tag	Weakness tag
1	Bitten	Pneuma	*I've been bled and lived*	*marks on my throat*
2	Bitter	Psychē	*expects the worst*	*trusts no one*
3	City-Born	Psychē	*educated in the city*	*soft hands*
4	Charming	Pneuma	*a smile that opens doors*	*can't resist a pretty face*
5	Cold	Pneuma	*nothing shows on my face*	*pushes people away*
6	Coveted	Pneuma	*beauty the vampires notice*	*the Kept want me*
7	Scheming	Psychē	*always a second plan*	*too clever by half*
8	Devout	Pneuma	*faith the dark can feel*	*won't break my vows*
9	Doomed	Pneuma	*nothing left to lose*	*death rides beside me*
10	Feral	Mētis	*senses of a beast*	*forgets my manners*
11	Frontier-Hard	Sōma	*grew up on the Frontier*	*slow to trust strangers*
12	Gentle	Pneuma	*people open up to me*	*can't kill without cause*
13	Greedy	Psychē	*knows what everything's worth*	*a price for everything*
14	Hollow-Eyed	Psychē	*seen too much to scare*	*nightmares every night*
15	Mutated	Sōma	*body of the wastes*	*they call me monster*

#	Descriptor	Pool	Power tag	Weakness tag
16	Headlong	Mētis	*first through the door*	*doesn't wait*
17	Scarred	Sōma	*survived worse than this*	*old wounds ache*
18	Silent	Mētis	*says nothing, sees everything*	*people don't know where they stand*
19	Superstitious	Psychē	*knows every folk charm*	*jumps at shadows*
20	Vengeful	Sōma	*I don't forget*	*will drop anything for revenge*

3. Descriptors

1. Bitten

> *A vampire drank from you once and let you live. The marks never faded.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *I've been bled and lived*
- Weakness tag: *marks on my throat*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always keep my collar buttoned."
- Frontier hook: Which vampire bit you, and why did it stop?

2. Bitter

> *The Frontier taught you that hope is how people get killed.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *expects the worst*
- Weakness tag: *trusts no one*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always ask who benefits."
- Frontier hook: Who betrayed you, and do they still live?

3. City-Born

> *You grew up behind the city's walls, with books, machines, and safety. The Frontier is a different world.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *educated in the city*
- Weakness tag: *soft hands*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always look for the scientific explanation first."
- Frontier hook: Why did you leave the city, and can you ever go back?

4. Charming

> *People like you. Even the ones who shouldn't.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *a smile that opens doors*
- Weakness tag: *can't resist a pretty face*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always buy the first round."
- Frontier hook: Who in the last town is still waiting for you to come back?

5. Cold

> *You learned to feel nothing. It keeps you alive.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *nothing shows on my face*
- Weakness tag: *pushes people away*
- Suggested Instinct: "Never say goodbye."
- Frontier hook: What was the last thing that made you weep?

6. Coveted

> *You have the kind of beauty the Kept collect: as brides, as servants, as trophies.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *beauty the vampires notice*
- Weakness tag: *the Kept want me*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always cover my face when I travel at night."
- Frontier hook: Which vampire household has already sent for you?

7. Scheming

> *You win by thinking. Fights are for people who planned badly.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *always a second plan*
- Weakness tag: *too clever by half*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always know the way out before I go in."
- Frontier hook: What scheme of yours went wrong, and who paid for it?

8. Devout

> *The old faith is nearly gone, but you still keep it. Crosses don't burn anyone, but the rites still matter.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *faith the dark can feel*
- Weakness tag: *won't break my vows*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always pray before a hunt."
- Frontier hook: What vow did you make, and who did you make it to?

9. Doomed

> *A seer, a vampire, or a doctor told you how you'll die. You believe them.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *nothing left to lose*
- Weakness tag: *death rides beside me*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always volunteer for the worst job."
- Frontier hook: How will you die, and what must you finish first?

10. Feral

> *Raised in the wastes, by animals, mutants, or no one at all.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *senses of a beast*
- Weakness tag: *forgets my manners*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always sleep with my back to a wall."
- Frontier hook: What raised you, and is it still out there?

11. Frontier-Hard

> *Born in a fortified village and raised on dust, chores, and sunset curfews.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *grew up on the Frontier*
- Weakness tag: *slow to trust strangers*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always bar the door at sunset."
- Frontier hook: What happened to your home village?

12. Gentle

> *Kindness is rare on the Frontier. You haven't lost yours, yet.*

- Pool: +2 Pneuma
- Power tag: *people open up to me*
- Weakness tag: *can't kill without cause*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always offer the enemy a chance to surrender."
- Frontier hook: Who did you spare, and did they deserve it?

13. Greedy

> *Hunting is a job. Jobs pay. Better jobs pay more.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *knows what everything's worth*
- Weakness tag: *a price for everything*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always search the bodies."
- Frontier hook: What are you saving up for?

14. Hollow-Eyed

> *You've seen what vampires do in their estates. Nothing frightens you anymore, not even in your sleep.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *seen too much to scare*
- Weakness tag: *nightmares every night*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always stay awake on the first watch."
- Frontier hook: What did you see in the estate?

15. Mutated

> *The old wars and the old-world experiments left their mark on your bloodline: scales, extra senses, a too-long arm, eyes that glow.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *body of the wastes*
- Weakness tag: *they call me monster*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always wear the hood in town."
- Frontier hook: What is your mutation, and who first called you monster?

16. Headlong

> *Waiting gets people killed too. You'd rather it be on your terms.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *first through the door*
- Weakness tag: *doesn't wait*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always charge when they hesitate."
- Frontier hook: Who died because you didn't wait?

17. Scarred

> *Claw marks, burns, a missing finger. Every one is a story and a lesson.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *survived worse than this*
- Weakness tag: *old wounds ache*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always check the wound before the pain."
- Frontier hook: Which scar do you never talk about?

18. Silent

> *You speak rarely. People fill the silence with the truth.*

- Pool: +2 Mētis
- Power tag: *says nothing, sees everything*
- Weakness tag: *people don't know where they stand*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always listen before I speak."

- Frontier hook: Why did you stop talking?

19. Superstitious

> *Garlic in your pockets, salt across the doorway, a charm for every danger. Some of them even work.*

- Pool: +2 Psychē
- Power tag: *knows every folk charm*
- Weakness tag: *jumps at shadows*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always follow the old rules: no whistling after dark, no mirrors covered."
- Frontier hook: Which charm saved your life, and who taught it to you?

20. Vengeful

> *Someone took everything from you. You'll take it back, in blood.*

- Pool: +2 Sōma
- Power tag: *I don't forget*
- Weakness tag: *will drop anything for revenge*
- Suggested Instinct: "Always ask strangers about the one I'm hunting."
- Frontier hook: Who are you hunting, and what did they take?

4. Sample Sentences

- "I am a Bitten Frontier Doctor who Heals the Bled."
- "I am a Cold Sellsword who Carries Her Mother's Blood."
- "I am a Greedy Broker who Collects the Bounty."
- "I am a Feral Mutant who Hunts the Beasts of the Frontier."
- "I am a Vengeful Cyborg Hunter who Seeks Revenge on a Vampire."
- "I am a Superstitious Warden who Holds the Line Until Dawn."
- "I am a Coveted Occultist who Loves What It Should Hate."

CHAPTER IV

Frontier Playbooks

Nine ways to earn a living hunting the things that hunt humanity. Six reskin the generic playbooks; the Mutant, the Cyborg Hunter and the Warden are new to the Frontier.

Sellsword · Stalker · Frontier Doctor · Broker · Rider · Occultist · Mutant · Cyborg Hunter · Warden

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Playbook Overview

#	Playbook	Reskin of	Anchor	Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	Role
1	Sellsword	Bellator	Fight or Brawl	12 / 10 / 6 / 8	Front-line Hunter, bodyguard, stake-driver
2	Stalker	Furcifer	Stealth	8 / 12 / 8 / 8	Estate thief, assassin, day-hunter of sleeping vampires
3	Frontier Doctor	Savant	Medicine or Old Lore	7 / 8 / 13 / 8	Healer, scholar, treats the bled
4	Broker	Interlocutor	Persuade	7 / 9 / 9 / 11	Bounty broker, gambler, village elder, negotiator
5	Rider	Explorator	Frontier	11 / 11 / 7 / 7	Tracker, scout, marksman, horse-master
6	Occultist	Adept	Occult or Science	7 / 8 / 9 / 12	Psychic, curse-witch, old-world scavenger
7	Mutant	New	Athletics or Stealth	11 / 11 / 6 / 8	Monster-blooded fighter and infiltrator
8	Cyborg Hunter	New	Shoot or Fight	12 / 9 / 9 / 6	Rebuilt killer with implants
9	Warden	New	Craft	10 / 9 / 9 / 8	Village defender, trap-maker, siege leader

Frontier playbooks replace the generic versions. In Testament of Dust, use Sellsword instead of Bellator, Stalker instead of Furcifer, Frontier Doctor instead of Savant, Broker instead of Interlocutor, Rider instead of Explorator, and Occultist instead of Adept. These six Frontier playbooks replace their corresponding generic versions; the generic versions are not additional character options in this setting. Mutant, Cyborg Hunter and Warden are additional Frontier playbooks.

References to generic playbooks explain the underlying system or identify a reskin's source; they do not grant access to the replaced generic ability lists.

Dhampirs are not a playbook. Any playbook can take the Focus *Carries Her Mother's Blood* (*Frontier Focuses*).

Skill names follow *Frontier Rules* §3 (Ride, Frontier, Old Lore, Science, Occult).

I. Sellsword

> *Muscle for hire. You stand between the village and the thing coming out of the dark, and you hold the stake when it's time.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	12 / 10 / 6 / 8
Edge	Sōma 2, plus 1 in Mētis or Pneuma
Anchor skill	Fight or Brawl
Suggested skills	+4 Fight · +3 Athletics, Endure · +2 Brawl, Intimidate, Shoot · +1 Notice, Will, Frontier, Ride
XP trigger	Address a challenge with force or threats

Playbook tags (choose 2): *built like a wall · veteran of a dozen hunts · scarred and unbothered · iron grip · knows how a fight will go · the look that empties a saloon*



I.I Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Juggernaut	When you Resist physical harm with Sōma, reduce the status by 3 tiers instead of 2.
2	Stake Driver	When you make a killing strike (Frontier Rules §5.2) or drive a stake with Fight or Brawl, gain a free bonus die. On a success, the vampire can't spend Woe on *Blood Reserve* this session.
3	Bodyguard	When an ally within reach would suffer an imposed consequence you can fictionally intercept, you may take it instead. Declare this before their Resistance or harm reduction, and use your own eligible reduction instead. If you Resist it, your Edge counts as 1 higher for that roll. This includes a vampire's bite: you can take the bite (Bled) in their place. You cannot redirect shared Disposition loss, an injury-trade payment, a running-dry status, an agreed concession cost or another accepted payment. You cannot protect an ally from an area effect that already affects both of you.
4	Wade Through Them	When you attack a group or minions (wolves, retainer packs, mobs), you get one free Extra Feat per roll. Free waives the Power cost; it does not grant another scripted action or bypass the declared stakes.
5	Menacing	You may use Sōma for Intimidate Effort and Resistance. When you succeed on Intimidate against minions or a mob, spend 1 Momentum to make them flee, surrender, or freeze.
6	Pain Tolerance	Ignore the roll penalty from harmful physical statuses of tier 1–2. At tier 3+, the penalty is reduced by 1. This also applies to *Sun-Sick*.
7	★ Blood Fury	Once per scene, enter a fury: you get +1 bonus die (free) on Fight, Brawl, and Athletics rolls for the rest of the scene. You can't script Defend or retreat. At scene end, lose 2 Sōma or take *Weary*. The chosen cost is an accepted payment and cannot be prevented, redirected or Resisted; the pool cost must be paid in full. If you have afflicted blood, gain +1 Thirst.
8	★ Last One Standing	Once per scene, when a status would reach tier 6 on you, keep acting until the end of the scene. Then you're Taken Out as normal. This does not restore shared Disposition or reverse a settled defeat; record any Scar normally.
◆	A Name the Kept Know	Your reputation is a Campaign Truth (*"Vampires have heard of [name]"*). In Fight conflicts, vampire and retainer Disposition starts −2. Once per session, a vampire's pride compel against you costs nothing.

I.2 Starting Equipment

Signature weapon (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Longsword & stake belt (2) — *+1 Attack*, *stakes always at hand* (you never need to declare a stake as load)
B	Great-axe (2) — *+1 Attack*, *heavy enough to behead*: permits beheading using the killing-strike procedure (Frontier Rules §5.2)

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Leather and mail coat (light armour)
2	Plate cuirass and gorget (heavy armour; also counts as a steel neck guard)
1	Throwing stakes ×3 — *+1 Attack* (range); may stake at range using Shoot under Frontier Rules §8.1
1	Chain and manacles
1	Whetstone and oil
1	Flask of Frontier whiskey

Always carried (0): wooden stake, knuckle-wraps, a trophy from your first kill.

I.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "A village that pays me gets my blood, not just my blade." / "Vampires are only as strong as the fear they feed on."
- Goal: "Get the farmer's family to the next town by sunset." / "Drive a stake into Count Varnas."
- Instinct: "Always stand between my friends and the door." / "Never let a vampire finish its speech."

Relationships: Ally — a blacksmith who makes your stakes, an old hunting partner, a saloon keeper who gives you credit. Rival — a rival Hunter who stole your last bounty, a retainer who beat you once, a sheriff who wants you gone.

2. Stalker

> *You hunt by day. While the vampire sleeps, you climb the estate walls, pick the locks, find the coffin, and open it.*



Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	8 / 12 / 8 / 8
Edge	Mētis 2, plus 1 in Psychē or Sōma
Anchor skill	Stealth
Suggested skills	+4 Stealth · +3 Notice, Craft · +2 Athletics, Deceive, Shoot · +1 Fight, Science, Investigate, Old Lore
XP trigger	Address a challenge with stealth or precision

Playbook tags (choose 2): *light on my feet · eyes in the back of my head · steady hands · knows estate layouts · forgettable face · patient as a stone*

2.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Ghost	When you spend Effort on a Stealth roll, your first use of Effort costs 0 pool points. Once per scene, when spotted, spend 1 Momentum to declare you were never seen; you're in a nearby hidden position. Declare this when the spotting is established, before resolving consequences from being spotted. It does not undo resolved actions, Disposition loss, injuries or a settled defeat, and does not cancel an independently resolving action.
2	Coffin Finder	Once per day inside an estate, ruin, or lair, ask a free Discover: "Where does it sleep?" or "Where's the weak point in this place?"
3	Light Fingers	When you succeed on a theft, plant, or sabotage roll (Stealth or Craft), gain a free Extra Feat. Free waives the Power cost; it grants no additional scripted action and cannot bypass the interaction or declared stakes.
4	Infiltrator	Once per roll, ignore one Truth that would raise the Difficulty of sneaking, climbing, or bypassing security, including estate Truths such as *Guardian Machines* or *Shifting Halls*.
5	Quick Reflexes	Outside scripted conflicts, you always act first when violence breaks out. In conflicts, changing one of your unrevealed scripted actions costs 1 Momentum instead of 2, at the normal script-change timing. It grants no extra opening action, initiative cancellation or free actor reassignment.
6	Escape Artist	When you Resist capture, restraint, falls, or traps with Mētis, the cost is 0 on a highest die of 5+. This does not permit Resistance against shared Disposition loss, accepted payments or a settled conflict outcome.
7	★ Flashback	Once per mission, declare a flashback to something you prepared earlier. Pay Momentum by plausibility: 0 (obvious), 1 (reasonable), 2 (a stretch), 3 (wild). Then roll as normal; on a success, it happened. A flashback cannot contradict resolved events, reverse paid costs or outcomes, or retroactively recalculate Superiority after conflict setup.
8	★ Strike While It Sleeps	Against an unaware, *Impeded*, or sleeping target, Attack effects cost half Power (round up). Killing strikes against sleeping vampires are one step easier (−3 Difficulty; Frontier Rules §5.2). This reduction stacks with other applicable killing-strike reductions.
◆	Nobody Sees Me Coming	Once per session, declare you're already somewhere you could plausibly have reached. Your first roll there gets +2 bonus dice for free, and the GM can't spend Woe to reveal you during that roll. This grants no additional scripted action and cannot contradict resolved events or reverse a settled outcome.

2.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Wooden throwing needles (1) — *+1 Attack* (range), *silent*; may stake at range using Shoot under Frontier Rules §8.1
B	Grapple-line gauntlet (1) — *+1 Maneuver*, *climbs any wall*; Advance a climbing or entry clock +1 per roll

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Padded dark jacket (light armour)
1	Lockpicks and an old-world key-probe — *opens what's closed*, works on old-world locks at +1 step Difficulty
1	Long knives and garrotte — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Feint*
1	Smoke pellets ×2 — *+1 Feint*, Create *Thick Mist* (1 Power)
1	Climbing spikes and silk rope (15 m)
1	Hooded lantern and mirror shard — by day, throws sunlight into a dark room (*Sunlit* for one exchange)

Always carried (0): wooden stake, soft-soled boots, a lucky coin.

2.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "A vampire asleep is as mortal as anyone." / "Take what they stole, and leave nothing behind."
- Goal: "Find the Countess's coffin before dusk." / "Steal the key-crystal from the estate vault."
- Instinct: "Always find three ways out." / "Never be in the estate when the sun sets."

Relationships: Ally — a fence at the trading post, an estate servant who leaves the gate open, a mentor who taught you the walls. Rival — a guardian machine you've escaped twice, a thief who works for the vampires, a Hunter who thinks stealth is cowardice.

2.4 Handout — The Hunters' Field Guide

Hunters pass these notes from hand to hand. Give them to players as found knowledge. The guide is right about what hunters saw. Its explanations are another matter. The GM measures a vampire by threat rank (Frontier Rules §5.1), not by these classes. This handout grants no exception to the creature, staking or killing-strike rules.

THE KINDS OF THE KEPT, AS HUNTERS TELL IT

Winterers. The oldest and the worst. They go to ground for a generation and wake hungry enough to empty a village. Cunning, patient, and they know every family in the valley. *Hunters say:* the old ones sleep by choice, to outlast their enemies. Find the sleeping place and burn it.

Strays. Newly made, and it shows: clumsy, greedy, careless with their kills. They seldom last more than a few years. *Hunters say:* the blood thins with every making, and a made one is a weak copy of its maker. Kill them young and you'll have little trouble.

Tapsters. They take a little and leave you living, the way a tapster draws from a cask. Their donors wake dazed and remember nothing, and many go back willingly. They rarely kill. *Hunters say:* their bite carries a sleeping venom. Never let one near your neck, and never trust a town that seems glad of them.

3. Frontier Doctor

> *The only doctor for a hundred kilometres. You sew up Hunters, deliver babies, and know more about blood than anyone wants to.*

Base pools (Som / Met / Psy / Pne)	7 / 8 / 13 / 8
Edge	Psychē 2, plus 1 in Pneuma or Mētis
Anchor skill	Medicine or Old Lore
Suggested skills	+4 Medicine · +3 Old Lore, Investigate · +2 Notice, Science, Empathy · +1 Will, Shoot, Ride, Persuade
XP trigger	Address a challenge with knowledge, insight, or healing

Playbook tags (choose 2): *steady surgeon's hands · seen every wound there is · reads old books · the village trusts me · knows blood · calm in a crisis*



3.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Field Surgeon	Restore effects from your Medicine rolls remove 2 tiers per Power. (One cost reduction per Effect.) Increased Restore output does not override lasting-injury treatment limits unless another rule explicitly does so.
2	Treat the Bled	Your Medicine rolls to stabilise a character Dying from *Bled* are Standard 15 instead of Hard 18. You can give a transfusion without a kit. Other treatment limits remain unchanged unless another ability explicitly overrides them.
3	Read the Body	When you examine a victim, a corpse, or a slain creature, ask 2 free Discover questions about what did it and how.
4	Anatomy of Monsters	When you tell an ally a creature's weak point (a Discover you made this scene), that ally's next successful Attack on it gains +1 Power.
5	Chemist	In the Players' Turn, spend 1 Check to make one cypher from: *healing gel* (tier 3), *mind-seal patch* (tier 3), *blood ampoule* (tier 3), or *iron tonic* (tier 2: Restore *Bled* by 1 tier). Healing gel, mind-seal patch and blood ampoule use their standard definitions in Frontier Rules §9.1.
6	Bedside Manner	Use Medicine or Empathy to Restore fear and despair statuses. Once per scene, a successful roll removes *Frightened Villagers* from the scene.
7	★ Not on My Table	Once per session, when an ally is Taken Out by physical harm, they don't die: they're stabilised at tier 5, and wake after 10 minutes of safe care.
8	★ Serum	With a sample of a specific vampire's blood, run a downtime clock (6 segments). When it fills, you turn one of its weakness tags into a killing method (Frontier Rules §8.1). The party's Attacks against that vampire outside conflicts inflict +1 tier. During conflicts, the party's successful Attacks against that vampire gain +1 Power that can be committed only to that Attack's Disposition-loss effect; this bonus grants no individual status, cannot buy another Effect and cannot become Momentum.
◆	The Blood Bank	You run a reliable blood exchange. Once per patient per scene, a transfusion you oversee needs no roll and removes up to 3 Bled tiers from that patient. This is a fixed result: it generates no Power or Momentum, cannot buy additional Effects and is not multiplied by abilities that improve Restore's tiers per Power. You may instead use the normal rolled transfusion procedure in Frontier Rules §6; the once-per-patient-per-scene limit applies only to this no-roll benefit. Transfusion requirements and donor Bled-1 remain unchanged; *Treat the Bled* retains its kit exception. Suitable transfusion can provide definitive care at Bled-6: clear the Dying clock when Bled falls below 6 and its immediate lethal cause has ended. This does not restore pools, remove Scars, undo resolved death or automatically return a Taken Out patient to an ongoing conflict. Once per session, you can supply half a litre of blood to anyone who needs it. This becomes a Region Truth (*"The doctor keeps blood"*), and vampire households will send for you, or send against you.

3.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Doctor's bag (1) — *surgeon's tools*; once per scene, a Restore removes +1 extra tier; this does not override lasting-injury treatment limits
B	Old-world medical scanner (1) — once per scene, free Discover about one body's condition, poisons, or mutations. Depletion 1 in d12 (needs a new power cell)

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Bandages, splints, and morphine
1	Transfusion kit — needed for transfusion; *+1* on Medicine against *Bled* (Frontier Rules §8.3)
1	Revolver — *+1 Attack* (range)
1	Books of Old Lore — *the answer is in here somewhere* (Old Lore tag)
1	Microscope and sample case
0	Mule and medical wagon (vehicle)

Always carried (0): scalpel, spectacles, a small cross.

3.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Every life is worth saving, even a mutant's." / "Knowledge is the only thing the vampires can't take back."
- Goal: "Keep the mayor's daughter below Bled-4 until the Hunter returns." / "Find out what the vampire is doing in its laboratory."
- Instinct: "Always check the throat first." / "Never let a patient die alone."

Relationships: Ally — a patient who owes you their life, a city professor who writes back, a Hunter you've patched up too often. Rival — a quack selling charms against the bite, a vampire physician whose notes you stole, a mayor who wants the bitten burned.

4. Broker

> *Contracts, rumours, debts, and deals. You find the work, set the price, and make sure the client pays.*

Base pools (Som / Met / Psy / Pne)	7 / 9 / 9 / 11
Edge	Pneuma 2, plus 1 in Psychē or Mētis
Anchor skill	Persuade
Suggested skills	+4 Persuade · +3 Empathy, Deceive · +2 Notice, Old Lore, Will · +1 Investigate, Shoot, Ride, Intimidate
XP trigger	Address a challenge with charm, lies, or bargaining

Playbook tags (choose 2): *silver tongue · knows every saloon on the Frontier · reads a bluff · owed many favours · dressed like money · speaks the households' tongue*



4.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Silver Tongue	When you Create a social story tag with Persuade or Deceive (*the mayor will hear us out*), it costs 1 Power instead of 2. During a conflict, the tag establishes leverage or a supporting attitude; it cannot grant the disputed objective, reverse a resolved outcome or bypass the action interaction.
2	Contract Lawyer	When you successfully negotiate a contract (Frontier Rules §10.2), raise the fee one free step. Apply this once to the completed negotiation: after the single-roll result, or after winning a Negotiation conflict, not after each successful volley. A client who breaks a deal with you gains the weakness tag *broke their word to [name]*.
3	Ear to the Ground	When you arrive in a settlement, ask one free Discover about local rumours. When you confirm a rumour (Module C.4), add +2 to the d12.
4	Smooth It Over	On a successful Persuade, spend 1 Power to remove *Frightened Villagers* or *Feared and Despised* for the party for the scene.
5	Read the Room	Once per scene, ask a free Discover about what one person present wants most.
6	Courtly Manners	You know household etiquette. In a Duel of Wills, you may use Persuade to Defend. Compelling a vampire's pride (Frontier Rules §5.3) costs you nothing once per scene.
7	★ Contacts Everywhere	Once per session, declare a useful contact in this town. Pay Momentum by plausibility: 0 (obvious), 1 (reasonable), 2 (a stretch), 3 (wild). They exist and owe you one favour. This cannot contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority after setup.
8	★ Hired Guns	Once per mission, spend a wealth tag (*a fat purse* or better) to hire a minion group with 2 power tags and 1 weakness. It acts as one group and fights for you for the mission. It is one participant in your side's three-action script, continuous rotation and area-effect Disposition bonuses, with no personal Disposition track. Hiring it grants no extra scripted action or retroactive setup Help; its removal does not directly subtract shared Disposition.
◆	The Word on the Frontier	Your word is a Region Truth (*"[name]'s deal is law here"*). Once per session, before the next roll in an unresolved Negotiation or Argument conflict, end it in your favour; the compromise is at most Minor. This is an explicit exception to ordinary victory and compromise. It cannot be used after the deciding roll to reverse a settled defeat.

4.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Ledger of debts (1) — *everyone owes somebody*; *+1 Maneuver* in Negotiation
B	Derringer and a marked deck (0) — *sidearm*, *+1 Feint*

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Fine travel clothes — *dressed for any company*
1	Bottle of good brandy — *+1* to Persuade when shared
1	Letter of credit — counts as *a fat purse* once per mission
1	Forged papers and seals — *+1 Feint* in Argument or Negotiation
1	Revolver — *+1 Attack* (range)
0	Covered wagon and team (vehicle)

Always carried (0): pocket watch, calling cards, a vampire's old signet ring you shouldn't have.

4.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Everything on the Frontier has a price, even mercy." / "A Hunter without a broker is a corpse that works for free."
- Goal: "Get the village to pay double before we ride out." / "Find out who really posted this bounty."
- Instinct: "Always get half up front." / "Never sit with my back to the saloon doors."

Relationships: Ally — a mayor who trusts you, a saloon owner who passes on rumours, a Hunter you've represented for years. Rival — a rival broker in the city, a vampire's agent who outbids you, a client you cheated.

5. Rider

> *Born in the saddle and raised on the open Frontier. You find the tracks, read the weather, and hit what you aim at.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	11 / 11 / 7 / 7
Edge	Sōma 1, Mētis 1, plus 1 in any pool
Anchor skill	Frontier
Suggested skills	+4 Frontier · +3 Ride, Shoot · +2 Notice, Athletics, Endure · +1 Stealth, Fight, Medicine, Old Lore
XP trigger	Address a challenge with endurance or the land

Playbook tags (choose 2): *never lost* · *reads tracks like a book* · *one with my horse* · *dead-eye* · *knows the weather* · *desert-tough*



5.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Tracker	Once per scene, free Discover from tracks, spoor, or blood. In a Hunt conflict, your side's starting Disposition is +2. Discover may support applicable Superiority at setup, but does not automatically qualify for every category or recalculate it mid-conflict.
2	Desert-Born	When you're the Guide, a successful roll Advances the Journey clock +1 extra. You ignore the *Exposed* Grind condition from heat or cold.
3	Horse-Bond	Your mount comes when you whistle. Once per scene, get a free bonus die on a Ride roll. At Chase setup, your mount counts as one helper (+1 Disposition), not an additional helper bonus on top of counting the same mount normally. This does not grant it an independent scripted turn.
4	Long Shot	When you Shoot at long range, ignore one Truth that raises the Difficulty (*Dust Storm*, *Moonless*). From hiding, gain +1 Power on a success.
5	Weather Eye	You always know what weather is coming in the next day. When you Resist cold, heat, or storms with Sōma, your Edge counts as 1 higher.
6	Ride-By	Once per exchange while mounted, a successful Maneuver also removes 1 Disposition from the opposing side. This explicit exception inflicts no status, grants no additional Power and does not permit an injury trade against that loss.
7	★ Beast Companion	A mutant hawk, a wolfhound, or a desert lizard rides with you. It has 1 power tag and 1 weakness, gives free Help once per scene, and can scout (one free Discover per scene where it can reach). Free Help waives the pool-point cost, not relevance, bonus-dice limits or participation risks. These benefits grant no independent combat turn or personal Disposition track.
8	★ Outrun the Night	You can travel by night without halving the Grind clock. In a Chase against vampires or their servants, your side's starting Disposition is +3. Changing from another conflict type to a Chase within the same unresolved struggle does not refresh Disposition or reapply setup bonuses.
◆	Rider of the Frontier	Your legend is a Campaign Truth (*"No one knows the Frontier like [name]"*). Every Advance on a Journey clock you make counts double. Once per session, you arrive anywhere you could reach in two days, by sundown today.

5.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Long rifle with scope (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *+1 Maneuver*
B	Cyborg horse (0, vehicle) — *never tires*, *fast as the wind*, *+1 Maneuver* in mounted Chases

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Long duster and wide hat — light armour; +1 Sōma Edge when Resisting *Sun-Sick*
1	Canteens and water purifier — Supplies +1 in deserts
1	Bedroll, rope, and tarp
1	Binoculars — *sees for kilometres*
1	Snares and trap kit
1	Crossbow and wooden bolts — *+1 Attack* (range), *bolts are stakes*

Always carried (0): knife, flint striker, compass.

5.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "The land tells the truth, even when people don't." / "A horse is worth more than most men."
- Goal: "Track the retainers to their camp before nightfall." / "Get the party across the Sand Sea in three days."
- Instinct: "Always water the horse first." / "Never ride the same trail twice."

Relationships: Ally — a horse-breeder, a desert nomad, a hermit who shares water. Rival — a bandit chief on a cyborg horse, a rival tracker, a sand creature that took your old mount.

6. Occultist

> *Psychic, curse-witch, hypnotist, or scavenger of old-world machines. You use the powers the old world left behind, and the Frontier distrusts you for it.*

Base pools (Som / Met / Psy / Pne)	7 / 8 / 9 / 12
Edge	Pneuma 2 (Occult) or Psychē 2 (Science), plus 1 in any other pool
Anchor skill	Occult (psychic powers, curses, sorcery) or Science (old-world machines, gadgets)
Suggested skills	+4 Occult · +3 Old Lore, Will · +2 Notice, Medicine, Persuade · +1 Investigate, Empathy, Deceive, Science
XP trigger	Address a challenge with your powers or old-world works

Playbook tags (choose 2): *touched by old-world secrets · disciplined mind · sees what others can't · blessed by the old faith · tinkers with old-world machines · fluent in the old pacts*



6.1 Core Feature — Domain (free)

Use the Adept's Domain rules (Generic Playbooks §8.1) unchanged: workings with your anchor skill, scope sets Difficulty, each working costs 1 point from Pneuma (Occult) or Psychē (Science), and doubles on a failure or Success at a Cost cause backlash. Backlash remains an explicit additional consequence in conflicts.

In a scripted conflict, a working uses an otherwise permitted scripted action; Domain permission grants no additional turn and does not bypass action interactions or declared stakes.

Setting Domains:

Occult Domains	Science Domains
psychic force (telekinesis, mind blasts)	*old-world machines* (command guardians, open doors)
curses and hexes	*weather control* (with a tower or device)
dreams and nightmares	*gravity*
the astral self (leave your body)	*energy weapons*
puppets and dolls	*holograms and illusion*
beasts and familiars	*bio-engineering* (grow, mutate, heal)
shadows	*dimensional pockets*
the dead	*sound and vibration*

6.2 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Focused Channel	Workings inside your Domain cost 0 pool points if you don't use Effort on that roll.
2	Ward Against the Night	You can create protective statuses (*warded-X*) with Enhance. While warded, an ally reduces supernatural harm by +1 tier when Resisting, including fear, intimidation and Presence, and Resists bites (Bled) at +1. This protection does not reduce shared Disposition loss, running-dry statuses or accepted payments.
3	Sense the Unseen	Once per scene, ask a free Discover about hidden supernatural or old-world forces nearby. You always notice when an old-world work starts or stops near you.
4	Over-channel	When you use Effort for Power on a working, gain +2 Power instead of +1, but take *strained-1* as an accepted payment. Armour, Resistance, prevention, redirection and incidental clearing benefits cannot reduce or cancel it. Once recorded, it recovers normally.

#	Ability	Effect
5	Ritual	Given time, materials, and a safe place, run a working as a progress clock (8 segments for Formidable, 12 for Heroic). Ritual results can create Site or Region Truths: a warded valley, a broken weather tower, an estate sealed shut.
6	Familiar	You have a doll, a bat, a homunculus, or a small old-world drone, with 1 power tag and 1 weakness. It can scout (one free Discover per scene where it can reach), carry messages, or handle simple tasks. It can't fight. It is an asset, not an independent combat participant: it grants no scripted turn, personal Disposition or injury trade.
7	★ Second Domain	Gain a second Domain. Workings in it use the same rules.
8	★ Unleash	Once per scene, a working hits every target in an area or group, following the Area Effects procedure in Core Rules (provisional for playtesting). Explicitly inflicted statuses apply at full tier to every affected character. In conflicts, apply normal Disposition loss once to the opposing side, plus 1 per additional opposing participant affected; do not multiply full loss by the number of targets or add a status to an ordinary conflict Attack. A group represented by one participant counts once, not once per fictional body. Afterwards, take *Weary* or lose 3 points from your casting pool. The chosen cost is an accepted payment and cannot be prevented, redirected or Resisted; the pool cost must be paid in full.
9	Hex	Once per scene, before an NPC you can see makes a roll, spend 1 Tychē Point: that roll brings a complication whatever it shows, as if it were a twist (Core Rules §2.6). The GM may spend 2 Woe to cancel it as normal, unless the hex works through a folk remedy the target believes in (*believers*, Frontier Rules §8.1). This is an explicit complication, not an extra failure consequence; it cannot retroactively change the script or cancel an independently resolving action.
◆	Ascendant	Once per session, a Heroic-scope working succeeds automatically with 5 Power, no ritual required. In a conflict, declare it before the roll for your normally scheduled action; it grants no extra turn and a trumped action remains trumped. On an independent test apply 5 Power without rolling. In a versus test it wins with 5 Power unless the opposing action also succeeds automatically, in which case resolve a tie unless a specific rule says otherwise. No roll means no dice-based critical or complication. If you use it again before your next downtime, gain a Pneuma or Psychē Scar.

6.3 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Charm-bag of bones and hair (0) — *focus for my workings* (Occult tag); once per scene, a backlash causes 1 tier less
B	Old-world gauntlet (1) — *focus for my workings* (Science tag); stores one cypher in addition to your Cypher Limit

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Candles, chalk, and salt — *+1* on Ritual rolls
1	Mirror shards and a scrying bowl
1	Herbs, garlic, and wolfsbane
1	Grimoire or salvaged old-world manual
1	Tool roll and spare power cells (Science)
1	Pistol — *+1 Attack* (range)

Always carried (0): a ring, a pendant, or a tattoo that marks what you are.

6.4 BIG Examples

- Belief: "The vampires' power isn't evil; how they used it was." / "Every gift has a price, and I've already paid mine."
- Goal: "Break the curse on the well before the next full moon." / "Get the estate's guardian machines to obey me."
- Instinct: "Always look at a stranger's reflection." / "Never use my power in front of villagers."

Relationships: Ally — a teacher who vanished into an estate, a village wise-woman, an old-world machine that likes you. Rival — a psychic Hunter from a rival crew, a household's occultist, a priest who calls you a witch.

Field guide: Occultists read and argue over the hunters' field guide (Stalker §2.4). An Occultist may find that its causes are wrong; its observations are mostly right.

7. Mutant

> *The old wars and the old world's experiments made your bloodline something more, or less, than human. You can fight, climb, hide, and endure like a monster, because you are one, as far as the villagers can tell.*

Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	11 / 11 / 6 / 8
Edge	Sōma 1, Mētis 1, plus 1 in Sōma, Mētis, or Pneuma
Anchor skill	Athletics or Stealth
Suggested skills	+4 Athletics · +3 Brawl, Stealth · +2 Frontier, Endure, Intimidate · +1 Notice, Fight, Deceive, Will
XP trigger	Address a challenge with your mutations or your monstrous nature

Playbook tags (choose 2): *born in the wastes* · *stronger than I look* · *hides in plain sight* · *knows the monsters' ways* · *survived the experiments* · *proud of what I am*



7.1 Core Feature — Mutations (free)

Choose 2 Mutations. Each is a power tag that ignores load, plus a rule. Every Mutation is visible unless you hide it (a hood, a cloak, a Deceive roll). When it's seen, the scene gains *Feared and Despised*.

Mutation	Tag	Rule
Claws and fangs	*natural weapons*	*+1 Attack* in Fights; your Brawl counts as armed
Hide or scales	*thick hide*	*Armour 1*, stacks with no worn armour
Chameleon skin	*blends in*	Once per scene, take a free bonus die on a Stealth roll in natural surroundings
Wall-crawler	*clings to anything*	Climb any surface without a roll unless under attack
Night eyes	*sees in the dark*	Ignore *Moonless* and darkness Truths
Shadow-melder (retainer clan)	*one with the shadows*	Once per scene, move from one shadow to another you can see (no roll unless guarded)
Venom	*poisonous*	Spend 1 Power on an Attack to add *poisoned-1*, which rises by 1 each scene until treated
Elastic body	*stretches and squeezes*	Reach 5 m; fit through any gap a hand can pass
Burrower (sand or soil)	*swims through earth*	Move under sand or soft soil; *+1 Maneuver* in desert Fights
Regeneration	*heals fast*	A short rest restores 2 + Edge Sōma and lowers one physical status by 1. Pool recovery and status healing are separate; neither restores Disposition, refreshes an injury trade or erases a Scar.
Mimic	*voices and faces*	Copy a voice you've heard, or reshape your face for a scene (*+1 Feint*)
Shapeshifter (retainer clan)	*beast form*	Turn into one animal (wolf, bat, panther) for a scene; you keep your pools and skills but can't use gear

7.2 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Further Mutation	Gain one more Mutation. You can take this ability up to twice.
2	Old Oath	Retainer clans and household servants recognise your blood. Once per scene, Persuade or Intimidate with them is one step easier, or ask a free Discover about their tricks.
3	Toxic Blood	Anything that bites or drinks from you gains *poisoned-2*. *Bled* from feeding gains 1 fewer tier on you. This reduction applies to imposed blood loss, not Bled accepted as payment for a benefit.
4	Waste-Hardened	Ignore the *Exposed* and *Sick* Grind conditions when they come from radiation, poison, or bad water.

#	Ability	Effect
5	Monstrous Presence	You may use Sōma for Intimidate Effort and Resistance. Against minions, a successful Intimidate makes them flee for 1 Momentum.
6	Hunter's Senses	You can smell blood, fear, and the afflicted. Once per scene, free Discover: "Who here is not what they seem?"
7	★ Full Transformation	Once per scene, release your monstrous form: gain a free +1 bonus die on Brawl, Athletics, and Stealth for the rest of the scene. While transformed, your successful conflict Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. When an Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This bonus adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve staking or killing strikes. You can't speak or use gear. Afterwards, take *Weary* as an accepted payment; prevention, redirection, Resistance and incidental clearing benefits cannot cancel that payment. Any humans present treat you as a threat.
8	★ Living Weapon	Choose one Mutation. Its tag may add +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3 from tags), and successful rolls using it gain +1 Power.
◆	The Clan Remembers	Your people are a Region Truth (*"[name]'s clan watches the Frontier"*). Once per session, the clan sends help: a minion group with 2 power tags, or a safe hiding place for the party. If the group fights independently, it is one participant in your side's script and continuous rotation, and one participant for area-effect Disposition bonuses. It has no separate Disposition track; its arrival grants no extra scripted action or retroactive setup Help, and its removal does not directly subtract shared Disposition.

7.3 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Hooked chain (1) — *+1 Attack*, *+1 Maneuver*
B	Hooded cloak and mask (1) — *+1 Feint*, *hides my mutation* (no *Feared and Despised* while worn)

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Hide armour (light armour)
1	Throwing knives — *+1 Attack* (range)
1	Bone charms from your clan
1	Water skin and dried meat (Supplies +1)
1	Climbing claws or digging tools
1	Bandages and salves for your kind

Always carried (0): a token from your clan, a scar from the experiments, a name nobody can pronounce.

7.4 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Humans and monsters are both just trying to live." / "I'll never serve the Kept again."
- Goal: "Get the village to let me in the gate." / "Find out which estate made my bloodline."
- Instinct: "Always hide the mutation before entering a town." / "Never run from a fight with a retainer."

Relationships: Ally — a human child who isn't scared of you, a clan elder, a doctor who treats you. Rival — a retainer still sworn to a vampire household, a Hunter who hunts mutants for pay, a mayor who posted a bounty on you.

8. Cyborg Hunter

> *Torn apart by a vampire or a monster, and put back together with steel, wire, and salvaged old-world parts. You're stronger than you were, and less human every year.*



Base pools (Sōm / Mēt / Psy / Pne)	12 / 9 / 9 / 6
Edge	Sōma 1, Psychē 1, plus 1 in Sōma or Mētis
Anchor skill	Shoot or Fight
Suggested skills	+4 Shoot · +3 Fight, Science · +2 Endure, Notice, Intimidate · +1 Athletics, Ride, Investigate, Medicine
XP trigger	Address a challenge with your implants or overwhelming firepower

Playbook tags (choose 2): *steel where bone used to be · doesn't feel pain · ex-militia soldier · targeting never misses · knows old-world machines · built to hunt*

8.1 Core Feature — Implants (free)

Choose 2 Implants. Each is a power tag that ignores load, plus a rule.

Implant	Tag	Rule
Arm cannon	*built-in gun*	*+1 Attack* (range); can't be disarmed
Blade arm	*built-in blade*	*+1 Attack*; permits beheading using the killing-strike procedure (Frontier Rules §5.2)
Armour plating	*plated*	*Armour 1*; stacks with worn light armour
Targeting eye	*locks on*	Once per scene, free bonus die on a Shoot roll
Booster legs	*jumps and sprints*	*+1 Maneuver* in Fights and Chases on foot
Sensor array	*hears heartbeats*	Notice heat and heartbeats through walls; a starving vampire's heart beats slow and strange
Grapple arm	*reaches and grabs*	Pull, climb, or seize at 10 m
Synthetic lungs	*breathes anything*	Immune to gas, smoke, and drowning for a scene
Pain dampener	*numb to it*	Ignore penalties from tier-1 and tier-2 physical statuses
Cortex chip	*data in my head*	Once per scene, free Discover with Old Lore or Science

Glitches: doubles on a failure or a Success at a Cost on an implant roll cause *glitched-2* (−2 on rolls with your implants) as well as the normal complication. Science (Restore) or a short rest with tools clears it. old-world works that disrupts machines (an EMP, an estate's defences) can inflict *glitched* as an Attack. This explicit glitch consequence still applies in conflicts; an ordinary conflict Attack does not inflict a status merely because an implant narrates it.

8.2 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Extra Implant	Gain one more Implant. You can take this ability up to twice.
2	Self-Repair	You can use Science on yourself to Restore physical statuses and *glitched*. Once per scene, a short rest also restores 2 Sōma. Pool recovery and status healing are separate; neither restores shared Disposition, refreshes an injury trade or erases a Scar.
3	Overclock	When you use Effort for Power on a roll with an implant, gain +2 Power instead of +1, but take *glitched-1* as an accepted payment. Armour, Resistance, prevention, redirection and incidental clearing benefits cannot reduce or cancel that payment. Once recorded, it can be repaired normally.
4	Little Blood Left	*Bled* gains 1 fewer tier on you. This reduces imposed blood loss, not Bled accepted as payment for a benefit. You ignore the *Hungry & Thirsty* Grind condition.

#	Ability	Effect
5	Heavy Ordnance	When you Shoot at a group or minions, gain one free Extra Feat per roll. Free waives the Power cost; it does not grant another scripted action or bypass the declared stakes.
6	Machine Tongue	You can talk to old-world machines. Science rolls to command, disable, or read guardian machines and estate systems are one step easier, and you get a free Discover in any vampire estate.
7	★ Combat Mode	Once per scene, switch to combat mode: free +1 bonus die on Shoot, Fight, and Athletics for the rest of the scene. While it lasts, Pneuma Effort costs +1 and you can't use Empathy.
8	★ Rebuilt Again	Once per session, when you're Taken Out by physical harm, you get back up at the end of the scene with that status at tier 3 and *glitched-3*. Returning does not reverse a settled conflict outcome, restore shared Disposition or erase a Scar.
◆	More Machine Than Man	Like a vampire, you're Hard to Kill: your physical statuses can't go above tier 5 unless the Attack uses Science, an EMP, or an equivalent killing method the GM names. Gain a Pneuma Scar (*more machine than man*) when you take this capstone.

8.3 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Stake launcher (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *fires stakes*: may stake at range using Shoot under Frontier Rules §8.1
B	Old-world laser rifle (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *burns through armour*, depletion 1 in d12 (power cell)

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Ballistic coat (light armour)
1	Spare power cells — recharge one depleted weapon or implant
1	Tool roll and implant spares — *+1* on Self-Repair and Science on yourself
1	Flash grenades ×2 — *+1 Maneuver*; Create *False Dawn* for one exchange (2 Power)
1	Combat knife — *+1 Attack*
1	Oil, solder, and painkillers

Always carried (0): steel neck guard (built in), a photo of who you were.

8.4 BIG Examples

- Belief: "Whatever's left of me is still human." / "The vampire who did this will die by what it made me."
- Goal: "Find a power cell before the arm runs dry." / "Get inside the estate's machine room."
- Instinct: "Always scan the room for heartbeats." / "Never let anyone see the wiring."

Relationships: Ally — the doctor who rebuilt you, a scavenger who finds you parts, a Hunter who knew you before. Rival — another cyborg with better parts, the vampire who tore you apart, a city agent who wants their property back.

9. Warden

> *Sheriff, militia captain, or the old soldier who keeps the village alive. You don't go to the estate; you make sure what comes out of it doesn't get in.*

Base pools (Som / Met / Psy / Pne)	10 / 9 / 9 / 8
Edge	Sōma 1, Psychē 1, plus 1 in Pneuma or Mētis
Anchor skill	Craft
Suggested skills	+4 Craft · +3 Old Lore, Shoot · +2 Notice, Intimidate, Endure · +1 Persuade, Fight, Frontier, Will
XP trigger	Address a challenge by preparing, protecting, or fortifying

Playbook tags (choose 2): *every fence post by hand · the village listens to me · old soldier · knows how they'll come · never sleeps on watch · wears the badge*



9.1 Special Abilities

#	Ability	Effect
1	Trapmaker	Spend a scene preparing an area. Create the Truth *Trapped* there for free. The first enemy to enter takes an Attack with Power equal to your Craft rating (no roll).
2	Garlic and Iron	With a scene of work and village help, ward a whole building or village: create *Warded Village* or *Custom of Invitation* as a Site Truth (Frontier Rules §13) until a vampire breaks it (6-segment danger clock).
3	Militia Captain	Once per scene, rally villagers into a minion group with 1 power tag (*pitchforks and torches*) and 1 weakness (*break and run*). If they fight independently, the militia is one participant in your side's three-action script and continuous rotation, and one participant for area-effect Disposition bonuses. Rallying them grants no extra scripted action and no retroactive setup Help or Disposition. Their removal does not directly subtract shared Disposition.
4	Night Watch	The party can't be surprised while you're on watch. When you're the Lookout (Module B.5), you get a free bonus die.
5	Hold the Gate	In a Siege Until Dawn, your side's Disposition is +2, and you get *+1 Defend* as a free action tag. Free waives a cost; it does not grant an additional action or bypass the normal tag cap.
6	Local Law	Your authority is a power tag with locals (*by order of the Warden*). Once per scene, a successful Intimidate or Persuade with villagers removes *Hostile Crowd* or stops a mob.
7	★ Hold Until Dawn	Once per Siege Until Dawn, tick the Dawn clock by 2 extra segments.
8	★ Killing Ground	In an area you prepared (with *Trapped* or *Warded Village*), allies' successful conflict Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. When an Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This bonus adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve staking or killing strikes. Vampires in the prepared area can't use *The Old Door* to leave.
◆	Nothing Gets In	Your village becomes a Region Truth (*"The Kept can't take [village]"*). A vampire must fill a 12-segment danger clock before it can enter. Once per session, any PC who retreats there clears one tier-1 or tier-2 status.

9.2 Starting Equipment

Signature item (choose 1)

Option	Item
A	Double-barrelled shotgun with silver-and-wood shot (2) — *+1 Attack* (range), *room-clearer*, *+1 Maneuver* against minions
B	Warden's badge and the village armoury key (0) — once per mission, draw one item from the playbook kit without it counting against load

Playbook kit (declare during play)

Load	Item
1	Leather coat and steel neck guard (light armour; neck guard)
1	Wire, nails, and bear traps — *+1* on Trapmaker and Craft for defences
1	Garlic, crosses, and lamp oil — *Warded* for a doorway (1 Power)
1	Flares and a signal bell — wake the whole village
1	Hatchet and stakes — *+1 Attack*, *stakes*
1	Lantern and oil

Always carried (0): the village's keys, a pipe, a list of the dead.

9.3 BIG Examples

- Belief: "This village is all I have left, and nothing takes it." / "Hunters come and go; I'm still here in the morning."
- Goal: "Get the fences finished before sundown." / "Find out who let the vampire in."
- Instinct: "Always check the doors at dusk." / "Never leave the village when a stranger's in town."

Relationships: Ally — the mayor, the blacksmith, a widow whose husband died on the wall. Rival — a Hunter who wants to use the village as bait, a council member who'd rather pay tribute, a vampire who has tried before.

10. Design Notes

10.1 Balance Targets

Playbook	Main pool	Conflict role	Exploration role	Social role
Sellsword	Sōma	Attack / Defend, killing strikes	Forcing obstacles	Intimidation
Stalker	Mētis	Feint / Maneuver	Estates by day, security	Deception
Frontier Doctor	Psychē	Maneuver (Discover), Restore	Investigation, healing, the bled	Expertise, trust
Broker	Pneuma	Negotiation and Argument lead	Rumours, contacts	Persuasion, contracts
Rider	Sōma/Mētis	Ranged Attack, Chase, Hunt	Travel, Grind, tracking	Local knowledge
Occultist	Pneuma/Psychē	Flexible (Domain), Duel of Wills	Supernatural and old-world access	Varies by Domain
Mutant	Sōma/Mētis	Attack / Maneuver	Climbing, hiding, wastelands	Monsters and servants
Cyborg Hunter	Sōma	Ranged Attack, heavy firepower	Old-world machines, estates	Intimidation
Warden	Sōma/Psychē	Siege of the Night, Defend	Preparation, fortification	Villagers, local law

10.2 Things to Watch in Playtest

- Mutant and Cyborg core features each grant two tagged abilities for free, more than other playbooks. They're balanced by *Feared and Despised* (Mutant) and glitches and a low Pneuma pool (Cyborg). If they outshine others, drop to 1 free Mutation or Implant.
- Hard to Kill vs. More Machine Than Man: the Cyborg capstone is strong by design at 12 Advances. Watch that it doesn't end the threat of mundane harm entirely.
- Warden is strongest in sieges and weaker on estate raids. Make sure the campaign has both, or let the Warden's traps travel (Trapmaker works anywhere).
- Free bonus dice (Stake Driver, Horse-Bond, Targeting eye, Combat Mode, Full Transformation) still count toward the +2 bonus die maximum.
- ★ count: each playbook has two Major abilities and a free capstone, as in *Generic Playbooks*.
- Hex gives the Occultist a ninth ability. It costs a Tychē Point and the GM can buy it off for 2 Woe, so it trades one problem for another rather than winning a fight. Watch whether it lands on every boss roll.



CHAPTER V

Frontier Focuses

Twenty Focuses steeped in the Frontier: afflicted blood, bounties, relics and ruins, the old faith, villages holding the line until dawn, and the people who love what they should hate.

Dhampirs enter play here, through Carries Her Mother's Blood.

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1. Focus Rules

Focus rules are unchanged from *Generic Focuses* §1:

Element	Detail
Power tags	2
Weakness tag	1
PC link	A prompt that connects you to another PC
Tier 1 ability	Fixed; gained at creation for free
Tier 2 ability	Choose 1 of 2; after 3 Advances, costs an Advance
Tier 3 ability	Choose 1 of 2; after 6 Advances, costs an Advance. Exactly one option is ★ Major (1 Refresh)

- ◈ Weird Focuses assume afflicted blood, old-world works, or the supernatural. In this setting all are allowed; the marker shows which ones draw attention from vampire households, Occultists, and frightened villagers.
- Generic Focuses: the 24 Focuses in *Generic Focuses* also work here. Good fits are *Never Leaves Anyone Behind*, *Masters a Weapon*, *Moves Like a Shadow*, *Never Misses*, *Opens Every Lock*, *Talks Their Way Out of Anything*, *Lives Off the Land*, and *Made a Bargain With Something Old*. Use the setting Focuses below in place of *Hunts the Things in the Dark* and *Is More Than Human*.
- Shared reminders: free bonus dice count toward the +2 maximum; only one cost reduction applies to a single Effect; abilities that add bonus above the tag cap are limited to +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3) unless stated otherwise (Generic Focuses §9.2).

2. Quick Reference

#	Focus	Category	Suits	◆
1	Carries Her Mother's Blood	Bloodline	Any	◈
2	Was Kept and Got Out	Bloodline	Any	◈
3	Hunts the Kept	Hunter	Sellsword, Stalker, Cyborg Hunter	
4	Collects the Bounty	Hunter	Broker, Sellsword, Rider	
5	Hunts the Beasts of the Frontier	Hunter	Rider, Mutant, Sellsword	
6	Seeks Revenge on a Vampire	Hunter	Any	
7	Bears an Old-World Relic	Old-World	Occultist, Stalker, Cyborg Hunter	◈
8	Plunders the Old Estates	Old-World	Stalker, Occultist, Broker	
9	Carries a Passenger	Old-World	Any	◈
10	Sends the Mind Abroad	Occult	Occultist, Frontier Doctor	◈
11	Keeps the Old Faith	Occult	Warden, Frontier Doctor, Sellsword	
12	Heals the Bled	Village	Frontier Doctor, Occultist	
13	Holds the Line Until Dawn	Village	Warden, Sellsword, Cyborg Hunter	
14	Forges Weapons Against the Night	Village	Warden, Cyborg Hunter, Stalker	
15	Rides a Cyborg Horse	Frontier	Rider, Sellsword, Broker	
16	Leaves No Name Behind	Frontier	Any	
17	Rides With Family	Frontier	Any	
18	Once Served a Household	Households	Broker, Stalker, Frontier Doctor	
19	Reads the Ruins of History	Households	Frontier Doctor, Occultist, Broker	
20	Loves What It Should Hate	Households	Any	

3. Bloodline Focuses

1. Carries Her Mother's Blood ◈

> *Dhampir. Born to one of the Kept, and carrying a little of what she is. Tougher than you should be, slower to age, never easy in the sun — and worth more to certain people than you'd like.*

- Power tags: *stronger than I look*, *eyes that see in the dark*
- Weakness tag: *my mother's blood* (when recognised, the scene gains *Feared and Despised* among common folk, or draws the interest of a vampire household that wants you as an heir, a key or something worse; GM's choice, compel normally)
- PC link: "[PC] knows who my mother was. I've never asked how."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Mother's Blood	You notice fresh blood anywhere in the scene, and by scent or taste you can tell the blood of the afflicted from ordinary blood. A short rest restores 2 + Edge Sōma (not in direct sunlight). This pool recovery does not clear statuses, restore Disposition or erase Scars. Some old-world doors and instruments respond to you: when you try to make one work, *my mother's blood* counts as a tag, and works best on things tied to her line. You're subject to Sunlight Syndrome and the Thirst (Frontier Rules §7).
2a	Dhampir Regeneration	Once per scene, lower one physical status by 2 tiers (no roll). Not in direct sunlight. Thirst +1 as an accepted payment; prevention, redirection and incidental clearing benefits cannot cancel that payment. Healing an existing status does not restore pools or Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.
2b	Read the Blood	Touch or taste a blood sample (a scene, no roll) to learn: whether it is afflicted, a dhampir's, or ordinary; whether the afflicted person it came from was well fed or starving; and roughly how long ago it was shed. With 1 Power from a Discover effect, also learn whether two afflicted samples share a bloodline. Thirst +1 each time.
3a	Mother's Key	Old-world systems tied to your mother's line accept you as one of her line. Once per session, make one such system open, start, stop or show its records — no roll. On systems of other lines, *my mother's blood* gives a free bonus die. The GM may spend 2 Woe to have the system note your visit somewhere someone will notice. Free bonus dice respect the normal cap; this benefit does not grant an additional scripted turn or reverse resolved events.
3b	★ Awaken the Blood	Once per scene, let your mother's blood rise (*Thirst*): until the scene ends, you get +2 bonus dice free on physical rolls, and your physical statuses can't go above tier 5, except that full-day exposure advances Sun-Sick from tier 5 to tier 6 under Frontier Rules §7.1. Your successful conflict Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. When an Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve staking or killing strikes. The bonus dice respect the normal cap. Afterwards, Thirst +2 as an accepted payment, and anyone who saw it treats you as one of the Kept. Prevention, redirection and incidental clearing benefits cannot cancel that payment.

Optional swap for combat-focused tables: replace 3a with:

Tier	Ability	Effect
3a (alt)	Knows How They Die	Against afflicted targets that are *Sun-Sick*, *starving* or *broken*, your successful conflict Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. When an Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve staking or killing strikes. Your blade separately permits beheading using the killing-strike procedure (Frontier Rules §5.2).

Table options for dhampirs (choose at session zero):

- Rare blood (recommended default): only one PC in the party can take this Focus.
- Costly blood: this Focus costs 1 Refresh at creation.
- The sun is merciless: Sun-Sick gains +2 per scene instead of +1 (Frontier Rules §7.1).
- Known mother: your mother is alive and identified at creation. She is an NPC with her own household and agenda. Gain a free bonus die on your first Mother's Key or Read the Blood roll involving her line each session; the GM gains 1 Woe at the start of each session she is involved.
- Unknown mother: you don't know who she was. Finding out is a Goal; the GM secretly decides her line.

2. Was Kept and Got Out ◈

> *You were a donor in a vampire household — by birth, debt or choice. You got out. They remember you.*

- Power tags: *I know how households run*, *I know how they think*
- Weakness tag: *they'll want me back*
- PC link: "[PC] got me out. I've never told them what it cost."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Household Ways	*Bled* gains 1 fewer tier on you. This reduces imposed blood loss, not Bled accepted as payment for a benefit. You get a free bonus die to Notice or Empathy when judging a vampire's hunger or a household's customs, subject to the normal bonus-dice cap.
2a	Old Ties	Once per session, a retainer or donor still loyal to you gives a Discover answer or a small favour. The household can find you the same way (the GM spends 1 Woe).
2b	One of Them, Almost	Retainers and donors take you for one of their own. Deceive rolls to pass among them are two steps easier.
3a	Unbroken	When you Resist Presence, intimidation or fear from a vampire with Pneuma, reduce the status by 3 tiers, and the cost is 0 on a highest die of 5+.
3b	★ Turn the Bond	Once per session, in a Duel of Wills against your former household, gain a free bonus die on every roll, subject to the normal bonus-dice cap. If you win, you also learn where it keeps its blood.

4. Hunter Focuses

3. Hunts the Kept

> *Your trade is the hardest one on the Frontier: you kill vampires.*

- Power tags: *knows where they hide*, *a stake for every heart*
- Weakness tag: *the Kept know my name*
- PC link: "[PC] was there for my first vampire kill. It went badly."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Know Your Quarry	Once per scene, Discover one of a vampire's weakness tags without rolling.
2a	Killing Mastery	Your killing strikes are one step easier (−3 Difficulty; Frontier Rules §5.2). This reduction stacks with other applicable killing-strike reductions. It does not reduce staking Difficulty unless an explicit rule says so.
2b	Steel Against Presence	When you Resist a vampire's Presence or intimidation with Pneuma, the cost is 0 on a highest die of 5+.
3a	Find the Killing Way	Upgrading a vampire's weakness tag into a killing method (Frontier Rules §8.1) costs 2 Power instead of 3.
3b	★ The Hunter's Mark	Once per scene, mark a vampire you can see. Until the scene ends, allies' successful conflict Attacks against it remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. When an Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve staking or killing strikes. The marked vampire can't use *The Old Door* to escape.

4. Collects the Bounty

> *A Hunter is a professional. You take the job, you finish it, and you get paid.*

- Power tags: *always gets paid*, *proof in a sack*
- Weakness tag: *money first*
- PC link: "[PC] owes me their share of the last bounty."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Professional	At the start of each contract, the party gains +1 Momentum. Once per contract, ask a free Discover: "What isn't the client telling us?"
2a	Beat the Competition	When rival Hunters race you for a bounty (Frontier Rules §10.4), their project clock ticks 1 less each World Turn, and you gain +1 Advance on any roll that gets ahead of them.
2b	Bring Them In Alive	Your Attacks can inflict *subdued* instead of harm. A target Taken Out by *subdued* is captured, and a living quarry is worth one step more bounty.
3a	My Reputation Precedes Me	Your reputation tag (Frontier Rules §10.3) counts as a free extra tag in Negotiation, adding up to +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3 from tags). Clients always pay half up front.
3b	★ The Big Score	Once per session, when you complete a contract, choose one extra reward: an artifact from the quarry's hoard, a Region Truth in your favour, or a second *vampire's bounty*.

5. Hunts the Beasts of the Frontier

> *Not every monster is a vampire. Sand sharks, werewolves, mutant spiders, old-world bioweapons gone feral: you hunt them all.*

- Power tags: *knows every monster*, *nets, poison, and patience*
- Weakness tag: *chases the trophy*
- PC link: "[PC] pulled me out of a beast's jaws. I still have the tooth."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Beast Lore	Once per scene, Discover a monster's weakness tag (not a vampire's) without rolling.
2a	Baited Trap	Spend 1 Power to Create *Baited Trap*. A beast that enters it is *Impeded* until it breaks free (an Athletics roll vs. Hard 18).

Tier	Ability	Effect
2b	Harvest	After killing a monster, spend a scene to harvest it for one cypher (tier 2–3) that matches its power: venom, hide, a gland, an eye.
3a	Bane of Beasts	Against monsters, your successful conflict Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. When an Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve staking, killing strikes or other creature-specific finishing procedures.
3b	★ Monster-Slayer	In Fights against monsters (not vampires), the enemy's Disposition starts −3, and minion beasts flee after your first successful Attack. Changing conflict type within the same unresolved struggle does not reapply the starting reduction.

6. Seeks Revenge on a Vampire

> *A vampire took your family, your village, or your life as it was. You'll find it, and you'll end it.*

- Power tags: *my hate keeps me warm*, *I've studied it for years*
- Weakness tag: *I'll sacrifice anything for this*
- PC link: "[PC] knows who I'm hunting, and promised to help me."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	The One	Name your vampire. You always know when you're within a day's ride of it, and once per session ask a free Discover about it.
2a	Cold Fury	When you Resist the named vampire's Presence, intimidation or fear, the cost is 0.
2b	Nothing Held Back	When you burn a tag against the named vampire or its servants, gain +2 Power instead of +1.
3a	Its Servants Die First	The named vampire's servants and retainers start conflicts against you with −2 Disposition. This is a setup modifier; changing conflict type within the same unresolved struggle does not reapply it.
3b	★ This Ends Tonight	When you face the named vampire, gain a free bonus die on every roll against it, subject to the normal bonus-dice cap, and killing strikes against it are one step easier (−3 Difficulty; Frontier Rules §5.2). This reduction stacks with other applicable killing-strike reductions, but does not reduce staking Difficulty unless explicitly permitted. If it escapes you, gain a Pneuma Scar.

5. Old-World Focuses

7. Bears an Old-World Relic ◈

> *You carry a piece of the old world's power: a sword that cuts anything, a pendant that opens one family's doors, a gauntlet that hums when old-world works are near.*

- Power tags: *the relic answers me*, *old-world steel*
- Weakness tag: *the Kept will want it back*
- PC link: "[PC] knows how I got the relic. It isn't a good story."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Relic Bearer	Start with one old-world artifact (Frontier Rules §9.2, or design one with the GM). It costs no attunement Refresh.
2a	Deeper Power	Your relic gains a second ability (designed with the GM).
2b	Well-Kept	Your relic's depletion improves by 1 (1 in d12 becomes no depletion).
3a	Relic Sense	You sense other old-world artifacts within a day's walk, and once per scene ask a free Discover about one you can see.
3b	★ The Relic Awakens	Your relic's tag may add +1 above the normal +2 tag cap (maximum +3). Once per session, it acts by itself: one automatic success with 3 Power spent on its listed Effects. In a conflict, declare this before the roll for your normally scheduled action; the relic supplies the action's automatic success, not an additional participant, turn or volley. A trumped action remains trumped. On an independent test apply 3 Power without rolling. In a versus test it wins with 3 Power unless the opposing action also succeeds automatically, in which case resolve a tie unless a specific rule says otherwise. No roll means no dice-based critical or complication.

8. Plunders the Old Estates

> *Every abandoned estate holds treasure, machines, and traps. You go in for the first, use the second, and survive the third.*

- Power tags: *knows old-world treasure*, *quick hands in dark halls*
- Weakness tag: *can't leave treasure behind*
- PC link: "[PC] and I came out of the same estate. Only one of us came out with the loot."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Salvager	In each estate, lab, or ruin you search, find one old-world cypher (roll on Frontier Rules §9.1) without spending Power.
2a	Appraiser	You know an artifact's tags, ability, depletion, and quirk as soon as you handle it.
2b	Tomb Sense	When you enter a room, the GM reveals any trap Truths in it. When you Resist traps, your Edge counts as 1 higher. This does not permit Resistance against shared Disposition loss, accepted payments or a settled conflict outcome.
3a	Cypher Hoarder	Your Cypher Limit is +1.
3b	★ Thief of the Night	You may attune one old-world artifact at no Refresh cost, and once per session, take an item from a vampire's presence without a roll, as long as the vampire isn't actively watching it. The theft grants no additional scripted action and cannot contradict resolved events or reverse a settled outcome.

9. Carries a Passenger ◈

> *A voice rides with you, through a relic at your ear, a grille in a buckle, a speaker no bigger than a coin. It speaks from an old-world site somewhere behind you: a shrine, an archive, a buried hospital. It says it was a person before the fall. It is rude, curious and out of date, and it has saved your life more than once.*

- Power tags: *a voice that knows things*, *the old works listen to it*
- Weakness tag: *it has its own plans*
- PC link: “[PC] is the only one the Passenger likes. That worries me.”
- Home site: choose it with the GM at creation. The Passenger can’t leave it; only its voice travels.

- Under open sky: out of range, the Passenger can still reach you through the moving lights (Frontier Rules §9.3). At the start of a scene under open sky, roll a d12: on 9+ one is overhead, and the Passenger can speak and use its abilities for that scene. Each time it speaks this way, the GM may compel *someone else heard* or spend 1 Woe to have the message overheard.

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	The Passenger	Once per scene, ask a free Discover: the Passenger answers, truthfully but not always helpfully, and often out of date. It can talk to others through the relic, which is often a compel. Range: it speaks only within reach of its home site's relays, by default about a day's ride. Out of range it goes quiet and this Focus's abilities don't work. A working old-world relay (a lit terminal, a speaker grille, a site where the lights are still on) lets it speak for that scene; finding or waking one may take a Science roll. These benefits grant no separate Disposition track, injury trade or independent combat turn.
2a	Override	Once per scene, the Passenger takes hold of an old-world effect it can reach (a cypher, a guardian, a door, the lights, a trap or machine): Disrupt it for 0 Power. Free waives the Power cost; it does not grant an additional scripted action, permit cancellation after an effect has resolved or bypass the declared stakes. The GM may compel its curiosity afterwards.
2b	Talk You Through It	In the Players' Turn, spend 1 Check to bring it something it wants (a record, news of the present, a part for its site). Next session, once per scene, it talks you through field treatment: lower one of your physical statuses by 2 tiers. This treats an existing status; it does not prevent an accepted payment from being recorded, restore pools or Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars. Normal lasting-injury treatment limits remain unless explicitly overridden.
3a	Older Than the Kept	Once per scene, take a free bonus die on an Old Lore or Occult roll, subject to the normal bonus-dice cap. The Passenger remembers the age before the fall, or its records do.
3b	★ Do Exactly What I Say	Once per session, follow the Passenger's instructions exactly for one action: it succeeds automatically with 4 Power. In a conflict, declare this before the roll for your normally scheduled action; it grants no additional turn and a trumped action remains trumped. On an independent test apply 4 Power without rolling. In a versus test it wins with 4 Power unless the opposing action also succeeds automatically, in which case resolve a tie unless a specific rule says otherwise. No roll means no dice-based critical or complication. Then the GM names the price it demands (a record, a favour, a secret, a visit to its home site, a scene where you do only what it says). Any price accepted as payment cannot then be prevented, redirected or Resisted.

6. Occult Focuses

10. Sends the Mind Abroad ◈

> *A sliver of old-work sits behind your ear. A teacher set it there, or a household surgeon, or you woke with it. When you close your eyes, your mind slips into whatever old works still run around you: the glass eyes in estate walls, the door that remembers every hand, the speaker in the chapel roof. Folk call it walking abroad.*

- Power tags: *my mind rides the old wires*, *eyes in every working wall*
- Weakness tag: *my body lies helpless*
- PC link: "[PC] watches over my body when I go walking. I trust no one else."
- Old works only: you sense only through old-world works that still run: lenses, doors, speakers, instruments and the relays between them. Where none run, you are blind and deaf.
- Under open sky: beyond your relays, the moving lights can carry you (Frontier Rules §9.3). At the start of a scene under open sky, roll a d12: on 9+ one is overhead, and for that scene you can use this Focus through it. You can look down on open ground within your range, or reach old works standing under open sky. Each time, the GM may compel *someone else is looking too* or spend 1 Woe to have you noticed.

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Walk Abroad	Send your senses into the working old works around you (range about 1 km). You use Occult for Stealth and Notice while you're out. Your body is helpless: it cannot take physical actions while your senses are abroad. This is an ongoing fictional restriction, not the temporary Impede effect or a tiered status. You may still pursue a conflict objective through your projected senses when the fiction allows; projection alone does not remove your participation or subtract Disposition. Returning costs 1 Pneuma, paid in full under the normal voluntary-cost rules.
2a	Feedback	Through a speaker, lamp or screen in the target's scene, Attack with Occult, inflicting mental statuses (*terrified*, *dazed*) even on vampires. This is explicit permission to inflict the stated statuses, not an additional scripted turn. Ordinary conflict Attacks do not gain statuses merely from their narration.
2b	Read What It Saw	Ask an old work in reach 2 free Discover questions about what it saw or heard (a door's record of hands, a lens's memory), or speak through it to a bled or frightened person and Restore their fear statuses. Restoring a fear status does not restore pools or Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.
3a	Long Wire	Your range becomes a day's ride along working relays, and you can bring one willing ally's senses with you while they touch you.
3b	★ Take the Hand	Once per scene, take hold of one old-world machine in reach that can move (a guardian, a lift, a turret, a loader) and Fight with it. It uses your skills, and harm to it comes out of your Pneuma pool, not physical statuses.

11. Keeps the Old Faith

> *Crosses don't burn anything, whatever the stories say. But the rites are older than anyone can explain, the faithful stand together, and some vampires still believe. You keep the old ways anyway.*

- Power tags: *the faithful follow me*, *prayer steadies me*
- Weakness tag: *bound by the old laws* (you can't refuse sanctuary or lie under oath)
- PC link: "[PC] doesn't believe, but they carry the cross I gave them."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Holy Symbol	Your cross creates *Warded* for 1 Power against any vampire who *believes the old stories* (Frontier Rules §8.1). Against other vampires it does nothing, but you and allies who can see it gain +1 Pneuma Edge against fear. This protection does not cancel shared Disposition loss, running-dry statuses or accepted payments, and creating the ward grants no additional scripted action.
2a	Consecrate	In a scene of prayer, bless water or blades. The old rites call for silver in the water: blessed water and blades count as *silvered* (Frontier Rules §8.1) for the mission. This grants the listed silvered benefit, not an additional killing method or a status on ordinary conflict Attacks.
2b	Last Rites	Once per scene, every ally who can hear your prayer restores 2 Pneuma, and Resists fear with Edge +1 until the scene ends. Pool recovery does not clear statuses, restore Disposition or erase Scars.
3a	Faith Unbroken	When you Resist fear, Presence or despair with Pneuma, the cost is 0 on a highest die of 5+. This does not permit Resistance against shared Disposition loss, accepted payments or a settled conflict outcome.

Tier	Ability	Effect
3b	★ Holy Ground	Once per session, sanctify a place: create the Truth *Holy Ground* for the scene. Believers can't enter without defying a compel, and every vampire Woe spend there costs +1 while the faithful stand together. This does not retroactively alter paid Woe spends or resolved effects.

7. Village Focuses

12. Heals the Bled

> *You've spent years fighting blood loss: transfusions, broth and iron, and nights by the bedside.*

- Power tags: *the bled trust me*, *knows every stage of blood loss*
- Weakness tag: *can't abandon a patient*
- PC link: "I saved [PC] when they were bled white. They don't remember it."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Blood Specialist	When you treat *Bled*, you also learn how the blood was taken and roughly how much. Your patients can't gain more than 1 Bled tier per night. This protection cannot reduce Bled accepted as payment for a benefit.
2a	Steady the Donor	Patients you've treated in the last day Resist fear and Presence with Edge +1.
2b	Bloodwork	From a sample of a vampire's blood, learn one of its weakness tags (a free Discover).
3a	Hold the Line	While under your care, a patient's *Bled* can't rise above tier 4. This ceiling cannot reduce or prevent Bled accepted as payment for a benefit.
3b	★ Give of Yourself	Once per session, transfuse your own blood: remove *Bled* entirely from one patient (any tier up to 5). You take *Bled-2* as an accepted payment. Armour, Resistance, prevention, redirection and incidental clearing benefits cannot reduce or cancel that payment. Once recorded, it recovers under the normal Bled recovery rules. Removing the patient's Bled does not restore pools or Disposition, refresh injury trades or erase Scars.

13. Holds the Line Until Dawn

> *All you have to do is survive the night. You've done it before.*

- Power tags: *stubborn as stone*, *I've seen the sun come up before*
- Weakness tag: *won't retreat*
- PC link: "[PC] and I held a door together once, all night. Neither of us talks about it."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Buy Time	Once per night, any successful roll that delays the enemy also ticks the Dawn clock by 1.
2a	First Light	When the scene becomes Dawn, every ally restores 3 points to one pool. This does not clear statuses, restore Disposition or erase Scars.
2b	Stand Fast	At night, while defending a place or a person, your Edge counts as 1 higher when you Resist.
3a	Light a Fire	Once per session, create *False Dawn* for one exchange with flares, fire, or faith, without spending Power.
3b	★ Not Until the Sun Rises	Once per night, you can't be Taken Out until Dawn. When Dawn comes, take *Weary* and a tier-4 physical status as accepted payments. Prevention, redirection, Resistance and incidental clearing benefits cannot cancel these payments; once recorded, they recover normally. This ability does not restore shared Disposition or reverse a settled conflict outcome.

14. Forges Weapons Against the Night

> *Stakes that don't splinter, bolts that fly true, blades that can cut a vampire's neck. Every Hunter in the region knows your mark.*

- Power tags: *my stakes never break*, *forge and lathe*
- Weakness tag: *my weapons carry my mark* (a vampire can trace them back to you)
- PC link: "I made [PC]'s weapon. I want it back in one piece."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Hunter's Smith	In the Players' Turn, spend 1 Check to either give one weapon an extra quality, or arm the party with fine stakes (every ally has a *stake* tag for the mission, 0 load).
2a	Silvered and Blessed	Weapons you make count as *silvered*, or as beheading (a killing method) if they're blades.

Tier	Ability	Effect
2b	Field Armourer	With 10 minutes, suitable tools and access to the equipment, repair *damaged* armour and broken weapons. Your allies' armour absorbs a tier-4+ hit once per mission without being damaged. Armour still does not reduce ordinary Disposition loss or accepted payments.
3a	Masterwork	One weapon you make (choose its owner) may add +1 above the normal +2 tag cap (maximum +3).
3b	★ Old-World Steel	Run a downtime clock (8 segments) to make a weapon artifact equal to an Old-World Longsword (Frontier Rules §9.2). Its quirk is *my weapons carry my mark*.

8. Frontier Focuses

15. Rides a Cyborg Horse

> *Your horse is half-machine, tireless, and as stubborn as you. You've crossed deserts that kill everything else.*

- Power tags: *my horse knows the way*, *faster than anything on the Frontier*
- Weakness tag: *can't leave the horse behind*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only other person my horse will carry."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Cyborg Steed	You own a cyborg horse (vehicle, 0 load) with tags *never tires* and *armoured flank*. Once per scene, it gives free Help on a Ride, Frontier, or Fight roll. Free Help waives its pool-point cost, not relevance, bonus-dice limits or participation risks. This benefit grants no independent turn.
2a	The Charge	In the first exchange of a mounted Fight, your successful Attacks remove 1 additional Disposition when applying ordinary Attack Disposition loss. When an Attack instead inflicts a harmful status, increase that status by 1 tier. If an explicit effect inflicts both, choose one component for this bonus, never both. This bonus adds no status to an ordinary conflict Attack and does not improve staking or killing strikes.
2b	Upgraded	Your horse gains one Implant from the Cyborg Hunter list (Frontier Playbooks §8.1).
3a	Never Caught	In Chases, your side's Disposition is +3, and changing your scripted action costs 1 Momentum. This changes one unrevealed action at the normal timing; it grants no extra turn or free reassignment.
3b	★ Bond of Steel	Your horse becomes a companion that acts on its own in conflicts (one action per exchange, *+1 Attack*), takes its own statuses, and can't be Taken Out by minions. Its action occupies one of your side's three scripted volleys, not an additional volley. It participates in continuous rotation, has no personal Disposition track, and its removal does not directly subtract shared Disposition.

16. Leaves No Name Behind

> *You ride in, do what needs doing, and ride out. People remember the stranger, not the name.*

- Power tags: *nobody knows where I came from*, *gone by morning*
- Weakness tag: *no one to call a friend*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only one who knows my real name."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	The Stranger	Once in each new town, ask a free Discover: people tell strangers things they'd never tell their neighbours. Bad reputation tags can't be used against you in a town you've never visited.
2a	Ride Out at Dawn	Once per session, leave a town or a scene with no pursuit, as long as no one is holding you.
2b	The Stranger's Look	You may use Pneuma for Intimidate Effort. Mobs and minions hesitate: a successful Intimidate makes them hold off for a scene.
3a	Many Names	Create an alias as a power tag. Deceive rolls using the alias are one step easier.
3b	★ Legend Without a Name	Rumours of you become a Region Truth (*"A stranger rides the Frontier"*). Once per session, your opposition hesitates: their Disposition starts −2 in the first conflict.

17. Rides With Family

> *Brothers, sisters, cousins: a Hunter clan that rides together, fights together, and splits every bounty.*

- Power tags: *blood is thicker*, *we fight as one*
- Weakness tag: *family comes first*
- PC link: "[PC] is my kin, by blood or by choice."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Family Tactics	When you Help your kin PC (from your PC link), or they Help you, the Help costs 0 pool points. Relevance, bonus-dice limits and participation risks still apply.

Tier	Ability	Effect
2a	Kin Rider	An NPC sibling or cousin rides with you: a minion group of one with 2 power tags and 1 weakness.
2b	Shared Spirit	At conflict setup, each participating kin on your side (PC or NPC) adds +1 Disposition. Count each kin character once and each kin group participant once, not every fictional member of a single group. Joining later does not retroactively recalculate starting Disposition.
3a	Avenge My Kin	When a kin is Taken Out, gain a free bonus die on every roll against whoever did it until the scene ends.
3b	★ The Family Name	Your clan is a Region Truth (*"Nobody crosses the [name] clan"*). Once per session, call on the clan: a warband (Generic Focuses *Warband*) joins you for one mission. It acts as one group participant for scripting, rotation and area-effect Disposition bonuses; it has no separate Disposition track.

9. Household Focuses

18. Once Served a Household

> *You were a household servant, a steward, a chosen companion, or a vampire's ward. You got out. The house hasn't forgotten.*

- Power tags: *knows household etiquette*, *they still think I'm theirs*
- Weakness tag: *the house still has a claim on me*
- PC link: "[PC] helped me escape the estate, and I never repaid them."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Inside Knowledge	Once per scene in any estate of your former house, ask a free Discover. Once per session, ask a free Discover about any vampire's habits.
2a	Pass as a Servant	In vampire estates, servants and guardian machines ignore you unless you act against them, or a vampire looks at you directly.
2b	Old Loyalties	Once per session, a former fellow servant helps you: a secret passage, a warning, a key, or a hiding place. This cannot contradict resolved events or retroactively recalculate Superiority after setup.
3a	The Master's Secrets	You know one weakness of your former master. Upgrading it into a killing method costs 1 Power.
3b	★ Turncoat's Key	Once per session, open any door or switch off any defence in an estate of your former house, without a roll. This grants no additional scripted turn and does not undo a resolved action or settled outcome.

19. Reads the Ruins of History

> *You study the old world, the rise of the Kept, and the founders whose names are still on the doors. Most of it is lost. Some of it isn't.*

- Power tags: *reads the old script*, *knows the old wars*
- Weakness tag: *lost in the past*
- PC link: "[PC] found the book that started my obsession."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Archive Mind	Once per scene, ask a free Discover with Old Lore about a place, a vampire house, or an ancient device.
2a	Decipher	Science rolls to use or read old-world machines are one step easier when you can study the controls.
2b	Genealogist	When you learn a vampire's name, you also learn its house, its rivals, and one weakness tag. This information may support applicable Superiority at setup; it does not automatically qualify for every category or recalculate it mid-conflict.
3a	History Repeats	Once per session, create a Site Truth from history: a forgotten passage, a buried weapon, an old treaty a vampire must honour. This cannot contradict resolved events, reverse a settled outcome or retroactively recalculate Superiority.
3b	★ The Ancestor's Notes	Once per session, with GM approval, reveal an ancient secret as a Region or Campaign Truth: a weakness shared by a whole bloodline, a hidden estate, the reason a vampire won't die. This does not itself destroy a creature or replace an expressly required finishing procedure.

20. Loves What It Should Hate

> *A vampire, a dhampir, a retainer, a monster. You love them anyway, and both worlds will make you pay for it.*

- Power tags: *love makes me brave*, *they listen to me*
- Weakness tag: *torn between two worlds*
- PC link: "[PC] is the only one who knows about us."

Tier	Ability	Effect
1	Beloved	Create your beloved with the GM: a creature of the night with 2 power tags and 1 weakness. They won't harm you directly. Once per session, they give you information or help. These benefits do not grant a separate Disposition track, injury trade or additional scripted turn.
2a	Speak for Them	In Argument and Negotiation conflicts with creatures of the night, your side's starting Disposition is +2. Changing conflict type within the same unresolved struggle does not refresh Disposition or reapply setup bonuses.

Tier	Ability	Effect
2b	For Their Sake	When your beloved is threatened, gain a free bonus die on your next roll to protect them, subject to the normal bonus-dice cap. This grants no additional action.
3a	Bridge Between Worlds	Once per session, broker a truce between humans and creatures of the night for one night. Neither side attacks unless the other breaks it.
3b	★ Love Over Death	Once per session, you or your beloved take an imposed consequence meant for the other, and ignore it entirely. Declare this before that consequence is applied; it cannot undo resolved effects. It cannot redirect or cancel shared Disposition loss, injury-trade payments, running-dry statuses, agreed concession costs or other accepted payments. The GM gains 2 Woe.

10. Design Notes

- Dhampir as a Focus lets any playbook carry afflicted blood: a dhampir Sellsword is the classic Hunter, but a dhampir Frontier Doctor or Broker plays very differently. The dhampir's edge is no longer raw power but access and information: reading blood, opening doors tied to her mother's line, and being wanted by people who matter. Sunlight Syndrome and the Thirst remain the price. *Knows How They Die* is offered for tables that want a fighter. Use the table options if it outshines other Focuses.
- Overlaps with playbooks: *Heals the Bled* stacks with the Frontier Doctor's *Treat the Bled*, and *Holds the Line Until Dawn* stacks with the Warden. Both stacks are intended specialist builds; none of them reduce the same Power cost twice.
- Vampire-specific Focuses (*Hunts the Kept*, *Seeks Revenge on a Vampire*) rely on killing strikes. If a campaign has few vampires, steer players toward *Hunts the Beasts of the Frontier* or *Collects the Bounty*.
- Sends the Mind Abroad works through an old-world implant and the relays around it, not a spirit. It follows the same open-sky rule as Carries a Passenger, and the same advice on placing relays applies.
- Carries a Passenger is an Old-World Focus. The Passenger is a voice relayed from a fixed old-world site, so it has a range; out of range the Focus does nothing except under open sky, where the moving lights give it a 1-in-3 chance each scene. On long journeys, place working relays often enough that the player isn't left without their Focus for whole sessions.
- ★ options are all at Tier 3, as in *Generic Focuses*, so a character can always choose a path that keeps their Refresh.
- Tag-cap exceptions (Bears an Old-World Relic — The Relic Awakens; Forges Weapons Against the Night — Masterwork): aligned with the Generic Focuses §9.2 fix — both now add +1 above the normal +2 cap (maximum +3) instead of ignoring it outright.

APPENDIX

Frontier Quick Reference

The setting procedures on one spread, for the table and the screen. The core procedures (the roll, outcomes, bonus dice, Resist and recovery) are in the Quick Reference of The 2d12 System.

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Day and Night

- Day: direct sun gives vampires and dhampirs *Sun-Sick* (Frontier Rules §7.1). Vampires keep indoors but aren't helpless.
- Dusk: the GM gains +2 Woe. Vampires come out.
- Night: vampires and dhampirs ignore darkness. A scene at night with a vampire present adds +1 Woe at the start.
- Dawn: a vampire still in direct light at the end of the scene gains *Sun-Sick* at tier 2 at once.
- Hard to Kill: a vampire's physical statuses can't go above tier 5 without a killing method: beheading, or sustained fire on a broken vampire (Frontier Rules §5.2, §8.1).

Frontier Skills

Renamed skills (Frontier Rules §3). All other generic skills keep their names.

Frontier skill	Generic skill
Ride	Drive/Pilot
Frontier	Survival
Old Lore	Lore
Science	Tech
Occult	Arcana

Woe Spends: Vampires

Full effects in Frontier Rules §14; use with Core Rules §9.2.

GM spend	Cost
Presence	1
Summon the Household	1
Uncanny Speed	1 (not at Blood Debt 4+)
The Old Door	2
Kennel and Guardians	2
Weather Turns	2
The House Answers	3
Blood Reserve	3 (once per session)
Retainer	3